

*Jay's
Struggle*

*By
Philosophizing Doodle*

*This book is dedicated to the continued
enlightenment and progress of humanity.*

*Sincerely,
The founder of
Partaceyism,*

Philosophizing Doodle

The Chapters of Jay's Struggle

The Beginning: Pages 3-18

The Business: Pages 19-39

The Dispute: Pages 40-55

The Realization: Pages 56-103

*This book was written whilst I was a dishwasher, so that I can dive
into the mysteries of hard work myself, enjoy.*

Chapter 1

The Beginning

(Jay's viewpoint) There I was; turning and twisting, all around me there was chaos. I have just opened a restaurant in Grand Rapids, Michigan and business was flagrantly booming. People from all walks of life were coming to be supplied with an experience at my restaurant. I view myself as experienced in the field of business since I graduated as a business major. Ahh! I remember those days, those horrors of college. Man, it was already so long ago, yet its influence on me couldn't be any greater. Suddenly, in the snap of an instant, James, one of my employees, came to me. In his tired, bent over state, James mumbled, "Hey boss, when can I clock out for the day?" At the moment of hearing this, I screamed at James, "Your leaving? What use are you if you leave! You must stay here till 9'o'clock! I will decide when you leave, understand that?! James looked at me with a stern look on his face, but he accepted his fate and went back to working.

James was always a rebellious worker, yet I always thought that I went too hard on James. Although, work is something inevitable and we all must deal with it. It doesn't matter if we like our work or not. What matters is that we do the work we are assigned to do. I learned that at a very young age. My parents would also drill that into my head. We cannot change the nature of work, therefore why go against work when all attempts against work are relentlessly futile.

My business model was nothing special, I simply ran a restaurant, I ordered supplies and satisfied the demands of my customers. My business is what you would call a local restaurant. My restaurant is not that massive. I get about 3,000 customers daily, but most of my customers are returnees. Although, that doesn't change the fact that the customers love what I do, they love the service I give to them! My business is a benchmark of goodness in an endless sea of laziness and depression within society. That is why I named my business, Benchmarks Seafood,

since I serve seafood, especially Walleye at my restaurant, my refuge of the values of hard work and dignity. Suddenly, over at the dull corner where I usually look at, I saw James with someone that looked strikingly familiar. Although, I couldn't get a good glimpse of the individual. Nonetheless, I thought nothing of it, since James was merely doing his job. Therefore, I opened and closed the door into the kitchen to check on my other employees.

(James's viewpoint) With my boss busy in the messy kitchen, I gave a quick check around to see if my boss was around. I did my assigned job and directed the old man to his seat, and I watched the old wobbling man sat at his seat. Although, while James was about to walk away to serve someone else, the old man firmly grabbed my arm. Full of shock and confusion, I decided to question the old man, "What are you doing?" The old man slightly turned his head to me and stated in a low raspy voice, "Hi sir, my name is Henry, I am the uncle of Jay Tabor. I need to talk to Jay Tabor." I was confused, yet curious as to who was this man named Henry and why did he need my boss? So, I asked him, "Why are you telling me? You should tell my boss what you want to say to him." Although, Henry continued his firm grip on my arm. Henry then stated back at me, "I can't, only Jay Tabor can help me, please can you get Jay Tabor for me?"

Confused, I gulped and decided to head into the kitchen to find my boss. I felt my every step was like a weight forcing me down. I was scared of the forceful mentality of my boss, but I could see that Henry needed help, I could just feel it in me. While I was walking towards the kitchen door, I heard Henry said to me, "Thank you, young man." I looked at Henry and smiled at him with a tired weak smile. Working here was a forsaken nightmare that reminded me of a rat getting tortured by a cat. I am that rat, and my boss is that cat. I tried to think more in depth on my experience here, but my bones and mind were weak, and my head was hurting so much. The sounds, the yelling, the disregard for me, all were too overwhelming for my existence to handle all at once. Anyway, forcing myself to get back into reality, I finished my walk towards the door. I then grasped the door handle, slowly opened the kitchen door, and then closed it, whilst expecting the worst to come.

(Jay's viewpoint) While I was explaining the duties of my employees, I heard the

door creak open and then gently close. Out came James, with a concerned look on his face, like always. All of my employees in the kitchen suddenly looked at James. To me, it looked like they were confused as to why he was not serving the customers right now. James was always the laziest of all of my employees, so to me this was not a surprise. I asked James, “James, what makes you stop working?” James looked around and directed his attention towards me and said in a shuddered manner, “Boss, your uncle wants to see you.” “Uncle!?” I exuberated. Full of confusion, I then decided to say to James in a confused furious tone, “I haven’t seen my uncle in decades? James, what nonsense are you trying to say!” In what looked like complete fear, James looked to be unstable, and he then fell to the wet floor and started to cry. I was amazed, how can a grown adult cry in such a situation? In a sarcastically mean manner, I stated, “Ahhhh, poor James, you should go back to work, working is how you’ll become a man once again.” Satisfied with myself, I asked James in a stern manly voice, “Now there James, go back to work.” James then tried to get back up. Although, while James was struggling to get back up, the kitchen door suddenly sprang open and then violently closed shut.

(Henry's viewpoint) I needed to get to Jay Tabor, I needed him, that is all that my mind could muster. The Tabor family could be in trouble, and I needed to talk to Jay Tabor. Jay Tabor was not a family sort of guy, he built the family business, but he always thought that the business was his alone. His wife, and 2 sons were essentially raised without a father. Jay Tabor always cared about his plans to create a business, so I needed to tell him about this pressing manner I had found related to his precious business. So, out in the open, in the dirty kitchen that Jay Tabor calls home, I shouted in my weak voice, “Jay!! I need to talk to you about something! If you don’t listen to me, bad things are going to happen!!” A man on the wet floor then got back up and I assumed he explained to Jay Tabor about my desire to talk to him. Although, I could not hear very well on what they actually said, since my old ears are giving up on me. Suddenly, Jay Tabor looked at me with an angry face and shouted, “Get out of here!! When were you when I was building this business! NOWHERE!! So, why should I listen to you now?” I was only trying to help Jay Tabor, both for his own future and possibly his future mental stability. I could feel that I needed to do this, but it seemed that my help was not needed. If Jay Tabor were to fail, then be it, it may be for his own benefit, who knows? Therefore,

defeated and unwilling to cause any more trouble, I decided to slowly open the kitchen door, and then I slammed the door, in hopes that Jay Tabor may understand what he has chosen for himself.

(Jay's viewpoint) He was so disrespectful to simply barge into my kitchen like that. My uncle was always a slacker when it came to work, he would place his own family above work, what a disgrace. It takes work to make a family, so what worth a family can be without work. My wife, sons, uncle, the whole Tabor family lineage has been slackers. I am the only one who has been successful in the Tabor family, so why should I sacrifice my time to such slackers. I then asked my employees at the kitchen to continue working till 9 o'clock, so that we can serve all of our customers. James, looking tired and scared, bowed his head and left the kitchen. I then walked towards the trash cans and thought about that interaction with my uncle. I thought about my uncle's warning about something that could threaten my business. What could be of such concern to him, that he would come to me in such a dramatic fashion? Only the lord knows of that question.

(The next day) On a sunny morning, I parked my car, and I took out my keys to open my restaurant. While I was unlocking my restaurant, I saw a newspaper on the restaurant's door. I took a look at the newspaper and I could not believe of the headline which stated, "Henry Tabor, uncle of the local business owner Jay Tabor, has stated to the public that he wants the entire Tabor family lineage to liquidate their assets to then be sent to Jay Tabor. Henry Tabor stated that the reason for this is to give Jay Tabor another chance at life, for struggles await Jay Tabor." What a madman! I was both very happy and very confused, besides what troubles await me? I am a business owner and a hard worker at that. Who would want to destroy me? Anyhow, I opened my restaurant and James, and my other employees came a half an hour later. While working, I looked around me and saw my hard working employees. I knew I needed to do something to save the business for their sake. Work is hard and work needs to be rewarded. Yet, I alone cannot save Benchmarks Seafood. I needed one of my most trusted business partners to do that. I needed to talk to my chief financial assistant for my restaurant, Kent Fortengal. So, what was thought is what was done and me and Kent had a meeting within an office room within my restaurant. Sitting with Kent, I had to ask Kent about the state of Benchmarks Seafood's financial situation.

Kent, with his confident look on his face, assured me that Benchmarks Seafood was financially well off, but then Kent stated to me in a confident voice, “Boss, our food delivery costs are getting abnormally high. You see, Jay Tabor, we are a small business. So, people like to ignore us. The delivery trucks are carrying less supplies towards Benchmarks Seafood than they were in the past. This is making the shipping company that is associated with Benchmarks Seafood, High Speeders, to raise their prices for food deliveries to Benchmarks Seafood. Obviously, this was done so that High Speeders can gain a profit in shipping to Benchmarks Seafood. Since, by doing this little trick of theirs, they can use the same amount of fuel to transport less supplies for local business in comparison to larger business customers.” I looked at Kent with a shocked expression. I didn’t think that this world would be so harsh to a small hard-working business-like mine. Kent then continued in a confident manner, “Therefore, since High Speeders raised their prices, Benchmarks Seafood was forced to raise their prices too. For if we didn’t, then we would be running at a net negative rate.” Kent then looked at me with a glance of assuredness in his eyes.

Confused as to where any assurance was at in this scenario, I asked Kent in a firm voice, “How can Benchmarks Seafood be able to solve this issue?” Kent looked at me with pleasure in his eyes and then said to me, “Boss, Benchmarks Seafood can solve this issue by talking directly to High Speeders to formulate a special deal to offer High Speeders a 5% share in the profits of Benchmarks Seafood. You see, we have no choice but to pay High Speeders a special deal to allow those at the top to see us as valuable. This is our only way to decrease our prices for our customers.” I looked at Kent with glee and I agreed with Kent. Thinking that my restaurant was going to be financially well off, I then decided shook hands with Kent. After shaking hands with Kent, I went out of the office of the restaurant to get into my old rustic car. I was in such a rush to get to the High Speeders HQ that I forgot to close any of the doors at my restaurant. I then started my old rustic car, and I drove to the headquarters of High Speeders to sort out this pressing issue.

Driving towards the headquarters was a very tense affair. I constantly talked to myself about the viability of this plan. A 5% share of the profits! This is a lot for a newly formed business. This economy makes it hard for companies to flourish,

since all of the expenditures adds up the costs in maintaining a business. Although, once I got to the shiny massive building, the headquarters of High Speeders, I decided to walk into the already opened doors of the main office section of the High Speeders HQ building. I then went to try to approve an appointment with a manager at High Speeders. I walked up to the front desk and the employee at the desk asked me, “What is your purpose at High Speeders HQ today?” I stated that, “Is it possible that I can have a quick appointment with the manager associated here for Benchmarks Seafood, Samantha Demandia”. The employee at the desk then stated, “This is very short notice, but it looks like it is your lucky day. Her schedule is free in about five minutes. I will call her of your arrival, enjoy.” I then sat down and waited for my associated manager. Those five minutes were the longest minutes of my life. The wait felt like a tsunami was coming, and I was waiting to be covered in its cold waters. A feeling of relief was something I wanted to happen, but like a tsunami, I could drown in despair as my encounter could wash me away like nothing had happened. This feeling mentally dragged me into a state of uncertainty for those five minutes. Suddenly, the door to the hallway of office rooms opened and closed and I saw her, Samantha Demandia.

(Samantha’s viewpoint) I saw Jay Tabor waiting for me and I said to him in a surprised tone, “Jay Tabor!? Is that you?” I was lucky that he noticed my calling to him, and Jay Tabor then followed me to my office room, we then opened and closed the door together as it was tradition at High Speeders to have a manager and their associated business owner to open the door together for a meeting. It was a thing we did at High Speeders to promote that we are a team with our customers. We then quietly sat down. Once we sat down, I asked Jay Tabor, “Jay Tabor, why are you here? Don’t you have a business to run? A new one at that.” Jay Tabor had a confusingly concerned look on his face and he stated, “I am in need of a deal with High Speeders, I wanted the executives to hear about this.” “A deal!” I exuberated with excitement. I then said back to Jay Tabor in a curious tone, “What deal do you propose to High Speeders?” Jay Tabor stated, “I propose that High Speeders should decrease their shipping costs to Benchmarks Seafood, so that Benchmarks Seafood can allow the continued sale of cheap Walleye done by hard workers. In compensation for lower delivery costs to Benchmarks Seafood, High Speeders will get a 5% share in the profits of Benchmarks Seafood for as long as the business survives for.”

After Jay Tabor finished saying his proposal. My first initial thought about this deal was that it sounded plain stupid. Why would High Speeders lower delivery costs to such a low demand area? Even with the 5% of Benchmarks Seafood profits, it's not like Benchmarks Seafood is all that profitable. So, it sounded extremely stupid, so I knew that the executives would not want to agree with this deal. Jay Tabor was punching way beyond his own weight. Although, I wanted to be nice to Jay Tabor, since things were likely not going to go his way. Therefore, I stated to him, "Jay Tabor, should you think about growing your business? Decreasing the delivery costs is something I cannot do alone for Benchmarks Seafood. Although, if your business grows, then maybe High Speeders would reconsider your deal?" Oh no, I think I messed up! I shouldn't of said what I thought. Maybe High Speeders would accept Jay Tabor's deal? Now, who knows? I saw Jay Tabor's concerned look growing in intensity by the second. It was clear that High Speeders would likely lose another business partner under my belt. Jay Tabor then began to scream at me, proclaiming in his screech, "I am done with your people, you big business people are always looking for profits at the expense of the little guy. Benchmarks Seafood is out of our business arrangement with High Speeders. Good luck!!" Jay Tabor then viciously opened the door and smacked it shut.

(Jay's viewpoint) Samantha Demandia is a horrible person, she is a disgrace to the hard workers of society! I stomped my way out of the High Speeders HQ, like a confident horse I walked out, going through their oddly opened doors. Although, inside of me, I knew that this confident little horse was next to a tsunami ready to destroy everything that horse had ever known. I decided to drive back to the restaurant in my old rustic car because I wanted to see how my employees were handling my company. When I got back to my restaurant, I saw that everything was normal. Although, I decided to not tell the bad news to my employees, since the normalcy of the business was more important to me than my employees knowing every little detail about my business. I saw James, walking with a leaning posture. He works a lot, mostly sloppy work, but whilst looking at his effort for a second, I became impressed. I felt like a whale looking at its children, I felt a sense of accomplishment while looking at James working with a beyond average commitment toward my business. Therefore, I sat down on a bench in my restaurant to amuse myself in looking at James's endurance. James then opened

and closed the door into the kitchen, supposedly to take care of other duties in the kitchen.

(James's viewpoint) I walked into the kitchen, and seeing my boss just look at me with desire was so sickening to me. I have no family, no friends, no life beyond working here. I was hopeless till I was hired by my boss because I would accept any wage imaginable. I am working 11 dollars per hour, and I still can't even pay for a rental. I live in a trash can next to the restaurant. I always hid there after my shift was done, so my boss wouldn't find me and fire me. This job is so demeaning and pointless, yet I must live. I must survive with my boss or go down with my boss. Destiny has a thing for tied up fates. As I stumbled in my demeanor, I began to wash the dishes. Whilst I was washing the dishes, I thought about my boss's absolute addiction to hard workers. He named Benchmarks Seafood after his idea that this restaurant is a benchmark for hard working culture. Yet, I can't see the beauty of it. I am too busy for that. I simply keep the show running on. Even if the show has flaws, what can I do about it? With that thought out of the way, I finished the dishes. Tired and exhausted, I decided to open the kitchen door and then I closed it behind me, so that I could focus on serving the mass of customers that I must serve, or I will pay for it.

(Jay's viewpoint) I saw James close the kitchen door and he went into the masses of people to who I assumed was to serve their interests. With curiosity, I looked at James. He was portraying a unique behavior of endurance that gave me hope for Benchmarks Seafood. Within the backdrop of the wooden rustic interior of my restaurant, I saw the vision of a hard worker's paradise. To tell James about the loss of our delivery partner would lead to his endurance ending. That would lead to my vision ending! I can't do that! Hence, I simply sat and watched James, be James, that lazy boy who endures hard work. A few hours later, when the sun came down, it became time for me to close my restaurant for the day. All of my employees came out of the kitchen, and I thanked each and every one of them for their hard work. James looked at me with a look of disgust when I thanked him, I never understood why James was always so upset about my congratulations to him. Although James is his own individual and I am simply doing my part to create an environment of satisfaction and efficiency within my workplace. If James does not want that satisfaction, then who cares, it is only James that is left out of the

satisfaction of hard work.

James then said to me in front of all my employees in an incoherent weaklike tone, “Sir? I am tired, and I have dedicated so much time towards this business. Boss? Can you confirm that the labor we all poured into this business will mean something valuable?” I heard James and I was confused at the statement he was saying. I shudderingly stated, “What are you talking about James? Your value in the business is within the continuation of the business.” James, in response to me, said in an exuberated manner, “Well then, I hope that this business will last a long time.” I looked at James with disbelief and I was slightly disgusted at his harsh demeanor at me. James then walked away from me into the sunset, opened the exit door to go beyond the doors of my beloved Benchmarks Seafood. (Two days later) The morning rose again, in the fashion of an epic awakening. I went to my small, wooden, rustic, and roomy restaurant to start another day. My employees came soon after, I was always surprised that James was the first one to come to work. He was a perplexing man on how he simultaneously gave off vibes that he disliked his job, yet he was always the first one to begin working. I saw James check in for work and watched as he walked towards the kitchen, tucked in the back of the restaurant. James then opened the door and gently closed the door into the kitchen behind him.

(James’s viewpoint) A new day, yet the same day. I couldn’t bear to walk another step. What meaning can my job, my place on Earth, possibly have? I walked around the kitchen, towards our storage. I thought about how yesterday was strange in that I never saw any delivery service come by. Although, it may be that High Speeders was delayed due to the vast number of clients they have. Well, at least that is my best guess. Although, when I saw the storage room, I noticed that we were not being restocked of our Walleye supplies. In fact, there was no Walleye left in our storage room. Walleye was our biggest seller, yet it disappeared like how my parents disappeared from my life. Yes, my parents, they died in a car crash in a traffic jam. There were too many cars, and someone wanted to pass all of them. Although, they lost control over their vehicle, and it happened to hit the car I was in with my parents inside. I survived, but what is survival when your face-to-face with death itself. My parents cared for me, yet they left me to live a life of meaninglessness. I was lucky to inherit their house, that is, until I accidentally

burned it all down by leaving the stove on for too long. Now, I am staring at another problem that I have to address thanks to someone who didn't know patience and failed to order more Walleye! While I walked towards my boss to tell him that we ran out of Walleye, I thought about why we were out of Walleye to begin with? We always had a delivery every single day for Walleye because it was just so popular. I opened and closed the door in a gentle manner and walked towards my boss.

(Jay's viewpoint) I saw James close the kitchen door and walk towards me. His walk gave off this concerning vibe of distraught and annoyance. So, I asked James, "What is the problem, James?" Suddenly, James responded back in a soft and sadden voice, "Boss, we have ran out of Walleye in our stock. Do we have more Walleye coming?" Once I heard this, I knew I could not tell the truth, but a lack of communication in a business is a sure way to end the business, so I had to tell James the truth. I stated, in a calm, yet distraught tone, "Well James, I believe that High Speeders is no longer delivering to Benchmarks Seafood. So, Benchmarks Seafood will have no more deliveries of any supplies for the foreseeable future." James looked at me with a sense of humor, he laughed. I haven't got the clue as to why. Although, he was laughing in a huffing tone that sounded like he was laughing out of the ridiculous concerning scenario we found ourselves in. James remarked at me, stating, "Boss, I trusted in you. I trusted that you would keep the business running, so that I can at least have a reliable income. Now, my income could be in jeopardy because of a silly supply issue?" I disliked James's attitude, for it was so inconsiderate of the effort I put into my business. Therefore, I quickly shouted to James, "All you care about is yourself! You are selfish, weak, and vulnerable, what kind of employee are you? Not a useful one at that! You're fired!" James looked at me with a sense of distaste in his eyes and he quickly ran away from me and opened and closed the rough looking exit door of my restaurant.

(James's viewpoint) I was so tired of my boss's attitude towards me. It was disgusting because he was so enthusiastically downplaying my labor towards the company to gain a foothold over me. Once I noticed that his behavior was trying to submit me towards the interest of his failing business, I decided to simply leave. I needed to get away from my boss. For if I can't do that, then I would go down with him. I can't do that, so I ran. The hard cement parking lot sounded like bombs to

my ears. I couldn't grasp the moment, I was free at last. No more submitting! No more pain! I am simply on my own. I still felt the fear of my boss in the back of my head, but what good is it now? I am already fired. I am just glad that I am out of the chains of Benchmarks Seafood's hard work culture. With a cheerful attitude within me, I ran towards a dirty, but not so busy gas station nearby and I opened and closed the door to go inside.

(Jay's viewpoint) I was shocked, no one ran away from me before like the way James did. I decided that my other employees may do the same if I told them about Benchmarks Seafood's predicament. Thus, I needed the help of my financial advisor, Kent Fortengal. I needed to fix my business with hard work and persistence. Therefore, I walked to Kent Fortengal's workplace, the main office of my restaurant, and I sat down next to Kent to have a chat with him. I asked Kent Fortengal, "Kent, your proposal to fix my business's supply issue with a deal failed. What can my business do now?" Kent expressed a deep sigh and paused for a little bit. After taking some time to think, he stated in a confident voice, "Boss, I think Benchmarks Seafood may not last long without another delivery partner. The best thing I can think of is that Benchmarks Seafood could create the closest thing we have to a Walleye."

Confused and curious as to what Kent meant by that, I remarked, "What do you mean by that?" Kent stated, "I mean that we use our remaining cod and catfish supplies to combine them together and we call that combination, Walleye, for now." It sounded like a good idea, Benchmarks Seafood would still be able to sell Walleye and I could simply decrease our larger and less popular stocks of cod and catfish to compensate. This would need hard work and persistence to work, which was the whole point of Benchmarks Seafood. It was the perfect plan, what could go wrong? Therefore, I said to Kent Fortengal, "Kent! That sounds amazingly brilliant. Thank you for your hard work in saving Benchmarks Seafood." I then opened the door of the office and left to go and check on the number of customers that came in today. I was so excited about the plan that I forgot to close the office door behind me.

Throughout the next five days, I allowed my employees to mix the cod and catfish together to create an abomination that I must call Walleye to keep my customers

coming. Although, with each long passing day, the customers to my restaurant decreased. I tried to find another supplier, but no supplier would give us a good enough price. With less wealth coming into my restaurant, my ability to find a feasible supplier decreased rapidly. It would only be a matter of time until Benchmarks Seafood ran out of catfish and cod.

On the fifth day, Benchmarks Seafood ran out of catfish and cod. Although, my restaurant now only had ten customers per day at this point. I didn't have enough money to supply the wages of my employees and buy supplies for my restaurant. Therefore, on the next day, I decided to sell Benchmarks Seafood to an investor. I did this, so my employees could still keep their jobs, so that they can still do hard work. Therefore, I decided to meet this investor, so that he may understand the idea behind Benchmarks Seafood and resurrect Benchmarks Seafood from the dead. I met with the investor, named Fred, on the pothole-stricken lanes of the parking lot of Benchmarks Seafood. So, I went out of my restaurant to meet Fred, yet I left the door open, since I was so focused on Fred that I forgot to close my restaurant door. I met Fred next to the large and annoying pothole in my parking lot at my restaurant.

After the two of us looked at each other for a little bit, Fred then stated in a reassuring tone to me, "Don't worry Jay, I will preserve the hard-working culture of this great restaurant. Your work will not go in vain." I gave Fred my deepest thanks to him in my facial expression that conveyed my understanding and agreement to what Fred said to me. Once I saw Fred's face flicker with relief, I took the opportunity to say to Fred in a refreshed voice, "Well then, I will miss Benchmarks Seafood, very much. I hope that you can build the hard working culture that I couldn't build myself." With that said, I began to leave the parking lot, full of fearful dread for my days to come. My dread made me feel a sense of unease, so I didn't want to drive my car. So, I asked Fred, "Hey Fred, can you drive my car back to my house. I want to walk alone to think about how I am going to live my life without Benchmarks Seafood." Fred looked at me with confusion, yet that confusion quickly melted away into understanding. Fred then said to me in an understanding tone, "I can do that for you, Jay. It is the least I can do for you." In acceptance of my decision, I decided to walk away from Fred. Entrusting him to my car like how I am entrusting him with my employees. Now, I could only walk

back home. Although, I waited to process my experience with Benchmarks Seafood. So, I went onto the street, and as the day turned into dusk, I walked aimlessly, without an objective nor goal to accomplish.

I walked across the dirty streets of Grand Rapids. I was sad, yet thankful that I at least helped out my employees for the time I had with them. I allowed them to develop endurance in the face of hardship by developing their skills in being hard workers. I thought about James, I personally believe that James still didn't get the message. He was complaining all of the time when he was working at Benchmarks Seafood. Complaining only leads to inefficiency, which hurts both my fellow hard working workers and my customers too. I wondered what happened to James when he fled Benchmarks Seafood, but I assumed that he is living his own life now, independent from mine.

As I walked, the street lamps gave way to a dark alleyway. My house was near, and I just wanted to forget the day and sleep. Suddenly, a figure appears in the darkness of the street. The figure was unrecognizable at first, but it was clear that it was coming towards me in a slow manner. It was walking with steps that looked like a trembling pole in the constant waves of an ocean. I was curious about the figure, so I said to it, "Hi, are you ok?" The figure came closer to me, yet it felt like thousands of years had passed, due to the figure's slow demeanor. When the figure got about 15 feet from me, it said in a tired, deep, and exhausted voice, "Jay, help me! I tttthhhi—" The figure suddenly dropped on the street, face first. It had fallen ungracefully, in a very quick and cruel manner. The sound it made put shivers down my spine, certainly whoever this person was, he needed medical attention. I came closer to the body, and I wished I didn't. What I saw was horrible, my uncle, Henry Tabor, was on the street, not breathing and in a complete silence. There was a large gash on his leg, it was full of blood. Henry had died from over bleeding? What? I stood there and witnessed the beginnings of death to my uncle. I screamed, "Whhhhhyyy???!!!!!!!", for I knew of nothing else to do at that moment.

I called the police, and they took over the scene. I decided to leave the scene when it became dusk because I had enough of this horrible night. In what felt like a whale on a poor man's broken and forsaken back, I struggled to walk my way back to my house. I hoped that at least my family was still alive. I was never close to my

family, but family is still family. Without the supply of my family, there would be no demand for any future family-run businesses that I may run in the future. I must see if the Tabor family still exists in this forsaken world. When I came to my nice medium-sized house, I thought that the worst had come. My house was empty, and I couldn't see anyone in there. I saw my old rustic car, empty and on the side of my drive through. It looked like Fred decided to walk away to wherever Fred goes within this harsh world. I honestly don't care; I am just thankful my old rustic car is at my home. Looking back at my house, I was firmly standing on my yard, yelling, "Daddy is home!" I started to cry when I heard no responses, which crushed my will to continue yelling at my house. Although, right when I fought that all was lost, a red mustang came up the road and parked next to my garage.

Out came, my dear wife and my two sons. My dear wife said, "Hi honey, looked like you miss us?" I proclaimed with a cheerful tone, "I missed you honey more than anything!" and I hugged my wife and me and my family decided to head into our house. Once they all organized ourselves and after I let the kids go to bed, I talked about my witnessing of the death of Henry and my dear wife was shocked. I calmed her down by saying, "Life may throw you lemons, but every lemon can become lemonade." My wife stated, "Jay, is that another one of your hard working culture jokes? What hard work can fix the death of your uncle? There are just some things that can't be fixed with hard work and persistence." "No", I exhumed. I then said in a calmly stern voice back at my dear wife, "The lemon is meant to show that Henry's death gives us the resources to think anew to turn his misfortune into fortune for others, like his own family." After I finish speaking, my wife said in a strict firm voice to me, "Jay, what can turn death into fortune? I think you should just relax, you've been through a lot." I agreed with my dear wife, yet what she said to me constantly lingered in my head as I went to bed.

Opening my eyes, I saw the roof of my living room and I looked around. I saw my dear wife sleeping next to me, in a state of deep sleep. I left the bed, and I decided to write a note next to my dear wife saying, "Honey, I am leaving for a while to get some personal time on my own." Once I placed the note next to my dear wife's head, I decided to get ready for this weird day. It had been a while since I didn't go to work. It felt unnatural yet calming at the same time. I knew that I had a lot of free time now. Therefore, I wanted to go to the library and grab some books to

read.

I wanted to escape from this world and enter into another world. So, I did what I wanted to do, like a puppy who needed a mother, I decided to get in my old rustic car all alone and I drove with a sad somber sense of hope that I may be able to escape my misfortunes. When I made it to the public library, I noticed that it was shiny and modern looking. Hundreds of people were lined up to enter the public library. I decided to go in line for the public library, which stretched as far as the end of the parking lot. After an hour went by, I was still in line, yet I was next to the check-in station to the public library. You see, this public library makes money on memberships, and I luckily had a membership. They created a check-in to allow membership members in and non-membership members out if they didn't want a membership. I came up to the membership station and I showed one of the station workers my membership card. They accepted it and I was allowed into the public library.

When I entered the public library, I was amazed. It was a maze of books and literature that spanned as far as the eye could see. The wooden aesthetic of the building felt humbling and comfortable at the same time. A soft sense of peace swept over me whilst looking around the public library. I first went into the Si-fi section of the library, which had amazing books and movies that everyone knew about. Although, I wanted something more obscure than cowboy or superhero books. So, I ventured onwards, and the abundance of books made me lose track of where I was. After what felt like a half of an hour of exploring and forgetting about the horrors of yesterday, I stopped walking and I looked at my hands. These hands had worked so hard, yet they were now going to be useless. I thought about my situation for a while, and I thought about what my dear wife said about how hard work can't fix death. If I were to disprove my dear wife, I must use persistence to escape my circumstances. This meant that I must find a book that was long, yet fun and exciting. I momentarily looked around me and I found something that caught my eye. A pink and white book was visible, it was a thick book, yet there looked to be only one in the entire public library. So, loving the obscure, I decided to grab it. The book was heavy, so I knew it would satisfy me by allowing me to escape from the misfortunes of my life. I let out a loud groan as I lifted the book. As I continued

to lift the book towards my eyesight, I began to slowly see the title of this heavy book, *The Partaceyist Manifesto*.

Chapter 2

The Business

I drove back home from the public library with *The Partaceyist Manifesto* in the front right seat in my car. I wondered what could be within the pages of this book as I drove back home. When I got back home, I ran home with *The Partaceyist Manifesto* in my hand, and I showed it to my dear wife. She said, “Wow Jay, what is that?” I stumbled on my words, saying, “I— Thiii—nk thi—s! is a rare newly printed book!” My dear wife looked at me with a look that reminded me of those looks people make then they think you’re crazy, yet they love you still. My dear wife then said to me. “Jay, why don’t you just talk with your sons? They never get to see you. It is like our family is just you and me.” I knew that I didn’t talk to my sons because I simply never related to my sons. They were uninterested in business, and they were always watching content on their devices. I always thought that if my sons didn’t care about me, then why should I care about them. My sons never talked to me, nor said hi daddy to me. That died a long time ago, ever since I went on a path towards making a business, I left my sons behind. Luckily, I still connected with my dear wife, but I don’t know how long it can last. So, I said to my dear wife a lie, “I do talk to my sons.” My dear wife immediately looked at me with disappointment and defeat in her eyes. She gave out a loud sigh and she shook her head at me. She then gave up talking to me and she simply went into the living room to watch a movie. I took this opportunity to go up the stairs to my bedroom to dive into the mysteries that *The Partaceyist Manifesto* may have.

In my bed, I read *The Partaceyist Manifesto*. It was a poetic and thawing book. As I spent hours upon hours alone in my room, I started to get the picture of *The Partaceyist Manifesto*. I then stumbled upon a peculiar set of paragraphs that strikes me as unnerving. *The Partaceyist Manifesto* had a very negative outlook towards hard work, which I found to be unnecessary towards the book’s message.

These paragraphs remind me of my lingering thoughts about me with Henry when he was dying. I couldn't do any hard work to help him, nor could he do any hard work to save himself. It is almost like hard work in that moment was useless. Although I knew that to not be true, I could have saved Henry, but my lack of knowledge about Henry's situation spelled his doom. Henry's death was not my fault, it was Henry's fault, since he didn't work hard enough to live on. After calming my mind a little bit, I looked more into *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, and I noticed that the book was also very critical of supply and demand. I felt a strange sense of arrangement with the author of *The Partaceyist Manifesto*. I too was exploited by supply and demand by the High Speeders corporation overpricing their deliveries to my restaurant, due to supply issues, which led to the downfall of my business with no fault of my own.

Therefore, within *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, the idea of creating a Partaceyist business struck me as an opportunity like how an eel stings its prey. I could build a Partaceyist business that uses mutual love and respect as a form of currency. I could use this untapped potential of the human emotional experience in a business to further fund the business venture I had envisioned. Better yet, since mutual love and respect can be produced by anyone, my customers could become net positive outcomes to my business venture. It was simply a win-win scenario. Happy and satisfied with myself, I kissed *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, and I went to bed with *The Partaceyist Manifesto* firmly in my arms. In the next day, I woke up to a weird noise that sounded like, ding dong, ding dong. After a few seconds, I recognized the sound as my door bell. So, I got ready for my day, so I could answer whoever was ringing my bell. My dear wife was sleeping on my bed, she is a very deep sleeper, no noise can wake her up. Once I put on my wrinkly clothes, I went to checkout to see who was ringing the doorbell. I opened my door and it creaked open and to show a familiar-looking face. The figure then quickly closed the door behind itself. Full of confusion, I thought that I was being robbed, but soon my sight revealed the figure to be James!

(James's viewpoint) I wondered what would happen to me? I couldn't even live in the trash can next to Benchmarks Seafood. All I could do was search for a place to stay and the only person that I knew was my boss. Now, I am here, standing next to what I presume to be the house of my boss. And yes, I was looking right at the face

of my boss. Who at first looked frightened, yet now he looked happy to see me? This was a very odd thing indeed, but if my boss is happy to see me, then maybe I can stay at my boss's place for a little while. So, I asked my boss, "Hi boss, is it possible that I could stay at your place for a little bit? I have nowhere to go." My boss looked at me with cheerful glee in eyes, as if he had an idea or something. My boss then said, "James! Come in! You're always welcomed to my house. Where would I be without your work for me?" I had no choice but to accept this. I had to choose to sleep in a nice house or the cold damp streets. Of course, I decided to accept my boss's offer to stay in his house. In my boss's house, I saw rows and rows of unclean dishes, as if no one was home. So, I asked my boss, "He—y boss, why are your dishes unclean? My boss then stated, "My wife never cleans things around here, nor my two sons. Don't worry, I'll ask my wife to do the dishes."

Suddenly my boss said in an enticing-like demeanor, "Hey sugar! Could you please clean the dishes in the sink." I then heard a quick, yet sad sounding "Yea honey, I got it." I could infer that something was off about their relationship, but it was not my business, so I moved on with my boss towards the basement of the house. Once we got towards the old looking basement, which had steps that creaked like the slight puffers of a bulldog's breathing. The whole house changed from new-ish looking to an old rustic vibe. This basement was obviously rarely used or cared for. My boss then said, "Sit here James. I have something to show you." Agreeing with my boss, who doesn't, I decided to sit and wait for my boss. My boss then went back upstairs and what felt like forever, I could hear the ramblings of my boss and his wife upstairs. Soon, the ramblings, as fierce as a viper, stopped, and out came my boss with a pink and white book. I asked my boss, "What is that?" He then said in an enthusiastic voice, "This is *The Partaceyist Manifesto*!" I exhumed, "*The Partaceyist Manifesto*?" My boss looked at me with a funny smile, "Yes, *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, it is the solution to all of our problems." I was perplexed at this statement, how can a book solve my desperate problems? It beats me.

My boss then showed me the content of the book and he stated with enthusiasm, "This book talks about building a business with mutual love and respect, something that you and I both can produce! You and I both can be rich!" Then, like a bag of eggs suddenly cracking on the floor, it came to me. I can produce mutual love and respect to save myself from poverty. This was miraculous! I then immediately said

to my boss, “I do need money, so I will agree with you, since I want to join your business venture, but why me?” My boss looked at me with his cunning eyes that pierced my soul with fear. My boss then said to me in a confident voice, “I need a business partner because I alone cannot do this. In order to create a new space of hard working culture, I will need people to be doing the hard work with me. You, James, were the first one to come to me and I know you can work, so you’re in?” This opportunity was amazing, but I knew that if I just agreed to the deal and left, then I would be trapped in a position under my boss. Although, at this time my boss felt vulnerable, which could mean that I could finally escape my fear of him, once and for all. So, I said in a shaky fearful tone, “I will join your business venture, but on one condition.” My boss said in a snarky voice, “What would that be?” I exhaled with a little bit of confidence, “I must be a co-owner of this Partaceyist business with you for me to agree with joining you on this business venture.” Suddenly, my boss said quickly and swiftly, “You got a deal!”

This was very surprising to me, but life is full of the weirdest of surprises. My boss was now my partner, yet I couldn’t help but see my boss as a bossy figure to me. My boss stated to me, “James, what do you think about making a new Partaceyist fish restaurant?” I looked at my boss with a sense of curiosity within me and I shook my head, up and down, in conformation with my boss. Then I stated to my boss, “It sounds like a good idea. Although, we should start small, like building a fish food truck in a local festival. How does that sound, boss?” My boss looked at me with curiosity like how a monkey gets curious over a bag of peanuts. He then stated, “I agree with you, James. Also, you can call me Jay, we are equals now.” I couldn’t believe it, I was given permission to call my boss by his name. So, I took the opportunity to say, “Thank you, Jay. Let’s get started.” We both decided to leave the basement. I opened the dusty and rough basement door for my boss and closed the door behind me as I prepared for the great things ahead.

(Jay’s viewpoint) Thinking about James climbing out of the basement. I thought, by simply looking at him, that he wasn’t the best person for the job, yet he was the only person I knew that would be desperate enough to do this with me. I hope this business idea is successful, I really do. While me and James walked out of my house, I said to James, “Goodbye James!” With that, James was gone. With James gone, I refocused on my dear wife. I went to check on my dear wife. Whilst

heading to the living room, I thought about the reason why I married my dear wife. I just so diligently loved her hard working attitude towards life. My dream was to live life with her as a hard working family who leaves behind a more hard working world than they left it as. Right now, I saw my dear wife watching TV, whilst the dishes were only half done. So, I asked my wife, “Sugar? Did you do the dishes?” She gave me a snarky look and said, “It was a lot of work, honey. So, I decided to do half of it today and the other half tomorrow. The kids won’t come down to do the dishes, they say that the dishes are too much work.” In anger, I shouted at my dear wife, “Too much work?!” I then shouted at the top of my lungs till they burned in agony, “Kids, do the dishes!!!!” My two sons came down in a rushed manner. Feeling like I did a job well done and tired of my loud demeanor, I decided to watch my kids do the dishes to delight myself. While looking at my sons, I noticed that their faces were so old looking that they looked alien to me. Although, that is just the sacrifice of being a hard worker in a broken world. I then turned my head away from my disappointing sons and watched the sunset out of my window.

(The next day) I woke up next to my dear wife on the living room couch. I guess the two of us both slept while watching TV. I suddenly heard my door bell ring. My first gut reaction was that it was James, and it was. So, I shouted at him while he was still outside, “James! Wait at my porch, I’ll be ready soon.” I got ready for the day and headed for my porch. On my porch, I looked around and James said, “Well Jay, I don’t see how we are going to get a food truck. I have no money and I doubt you have a crazy amount of money too.” I was concerned at the prospect of gaining the funds for a new business, even in a Partaceyist business, one must have money to get supplies to use supply and demand against itself. Yet, I looked around and I couldn’t find anything that may count as a food truck. That is, until I saw my old rustic car and a brilliant idea struck my head. I then shouted with enthusiasm at James, “My car can do!” James looked at me with the look that a puppy gives when you throw away their treat. He looked both very enthusiastic and disappointed in both the method and the strategy towards our business path. Yet, strangely, James quickly gave away that facial expression and looked at me and said in a defeated tone, “Let’s do this.” Then, me and James both got into my old rustic beauty, and I placed *The Partaceyist Manifesto* under a raincoat in the back seat to protect it from any possible theft and drove to the local supermarket to get some Walleye for my new Partaceyist business.

Whilst in the drive, James said to me in a concerned tone, “Jay, how are we going to earn money in our Partaceyist business? Like how will the love of a customer translate into wealth for our business?” I knew that it was a difficult question, but *The Partaceyist Manifesto* answered this question for me. So, I said to James, “The customer, by giving out mutual love and respect to us or evidence of their mutual love and respect done to others, will decrease the price of our goods or services to him/her. You and I will gain wealth from the collective rise, which increases by the increase in mutual love and respect produced and recorded in our food truck or car.” With only my left hand on the wheel, I demonstrated with my fingers on my right hand the process of the love economy. Looking at the road, I then said to James, “Let’s say the pinky finger is the customer and the leftmost finger is you. The leftmost finger wants 10 actions of love in the form of hugs.” I curled my pinky finger onto my leftmost finger, and I lost control of the car for a second. The sound was very screeching, like that of an angry mother bird that is protecting her kids. James gave out a huge scream, “Ahhhhhh!!!!” I quickly regained control over the car with my hand still in the position I had before I lost control over the car. I then said to James, who looked scared out of his mind, “Now then, the pinky finger does this hugging action 10 times.”

I then performed the curling around of my pinky finger over my leftmost finger 10 times to show James what I was talking about. I then said, “In response to the value produced by the pinky finger, the leftmost finger gives what the pinky finger wants, a bracelet.” I then tried to get a bracelet in the compartment of my car while keeping my hand positions intact and driving, but James got an old worn down bracelet from his pocket and placed it on my pinky finger. I then continued, “The bracelet to the pinky finger is given to it at a cost that was less than if the pinky finger didn’t do the hugging. This is because the hugs produced value that gave the leftmost finger wealth in compensation for the process of the selling of its bracelet. Therefore, since this wealth is recorded within the collective rise, it can be converted into money and the leftmost finger can be rich. While the pinky finger got a decreased price for the bracelet because the leftmost finger wants more money. So, the leftmost finger decreases the price of the bracelet to a fixed amount for the pinky finger to finally buy it at. This is done by the leftmost finger because the leftmost wants more profits, which can happen by producing more mutual love

and respect, which is done by decreasing the cost of the bracelet to the pink finger to its final fixed price.”

Gasping for breath, I finally finished my explanation and I de-curved my fingers and put both hands on the wheel. James looked at me with shock and said in response to my explanation, “That was actually a good explanation. Although, I didn’t like almost getting killed, I guess you would be losing profits from that.” I then said to James in a calm, yet happy voice, “Yes, I will James, yes... I will.” Then, the two of us both laughed our way towards the local thrift store to get fish for our food truck. I had read that supplies are ok to use for a Partaceyist business because the true issue is our over reliability on the structure of supply and demand, not the individual goods and services themselves. Once me and James got to the local thrift store, I left my car and walked towards the gloomy, yet modern thrift store. Eventually, me and James came upon the door of the store, and me and James walked in. As the automatic doors opened up, a woman walked out of the store next to me. I hardly noticed her as I walked into the store as the automatic doors began to close.

(Samantha’s viewpoint) I saw my car in the gloomy parking lot. I bought a few groceries that placed a slight burden on my arms. Yet, soon I arrived at my car and I placed my groceries in the back seat of my shiny blue car. I left the forsaken parking lot and I drove towards my work office at High Speeders HQ. The drive was a clean drive with little to no traffic and the roads were clean and pothole free like always. Once I reached High Speeders HQ, I walked in and checked in for work. I had a meeting today for High Speeders that I needed to attend, since all High Speeders managers were needed to be present at this meeting. I had no idea why High Speeders HQ needed all managers to be present at this meeting. It is not like every manager is important towards this company. Anyway, I must follow company protocol if I were to keep my job, so I walked in and seated myself in the meeting. A few long minutes later, the rest of the managers of High Speeders came in, there were about 100 to 120 managers at High Speeders. Yet, the atmosphere felt weird. It felt like everyone was confused about this whole ordeal to me. Everyone was looking around and talking to each other without a semblance of care about the future. It was truly a weird sight to behold.

Suddenly, out of nowhere, a man showed up to the meeting and everyone clapped their hands and cheered at him. I didn't know the man, but due to peer pressure by everyone else cheering for him, I cheered on too with the other managers. All of us then sat down and watched as the man began to present to us. The man said, "Hi, my name is Kent Fortengal, I am the new owner of the Fortengal Seafoods Corporation." Oh..., the man was the new owner of the former Benchmarks Seafood company. I remember Jay Tabor being the former head of that company, but he lost everything due to being unable to balance out his supplies and customer demands. I listened to see what Kent may offer to High Speeders. Kent said in a strangely confident voice, "I am here today to show you all what Fortengal Seafoods can give to High Speeders. We can offer High Speeders a 70% share of the profits of Fortengal Seafoods and in return High Speeders can be guaranteed higher delivery costs to goods being delivered to Fortengal Seafoods." I knew that the former owner of the restaurant didn't want higher delivery costs because it would make his business less profitable. Thus, I asked this insane guy, "How will your business make money? If High Speeders increase their delivery costs towards your company and have a 70% share of the business's profits?" Kent looked at me with a glance of excitement and said with a confident voice, "Fortengal Seafoods will be able to gain profits in exchange for my company to have a 60% share of the profits of High Speeders." Suddenly, the whole group gasped in shock. One manager said to Kent, "Why would High Speeders ever agree to such a deal?"

Kent looked straight at the manager in a directory way that conveyed confidence, way more confidence than he should have. Kent then said to the manager in a strikingly confident voice, "Think about it, if Fortengal Seafoods becomes a major restaurant on the local stage, then High Speeders will earn a lot of money with an unbeatable competitive advantage against any other delivery company delivering to Fortengal Seafoods. It is not a case of survival for High Speeders, only two things can happen to High Speeders in this deal. High Speeders can make a lot of money and reinvest it into other services with other restaurants, or High Speeders can buy out my business and sell it to the highest bidder if I fail." Thinking about Kent's little speech, he did had a point. This could be a promising venture for High Speeders, yet it was a lot to invest 60% of our profits to one singular corporation, a local corporation at that! Yet, as a woman, my voice was small, the other managers decided to unanimously agree with the deal with Fortengal Seafoods. The room

had a majority in favor of Kent's ridiculous deal. Sitting there in shock, I could only think that Kent was surely a brilliant businessman. In the midst of cheering and applause from the managers of High Speeders, Kent Fortengal opened the office door and then closed the office room's door with an honestly handsomely confident stride.

(Kent's viewpoint) I did it, I have done what Jay couldn't do. I have made a deal with High Speeders that wouldn't destroy the business. Supplies are now secured for my own business. Now, all I need is customer demand, the lifeblood of every company. I walked through the empty hallways of the endless offices within the High Speeders HQ. I walked with more confidence than I had ever felt before. I walked towards the end of the hallway. There was a window overlooking a parking lot. I decided to stare at that window overlooking the parking lot. In the distance, a festival was underway. The people looked like ants from where I stood, yet I was enslaved to the ants, since I needed to satisfy the desires of the ants. For that is the way of life! Everyone is a servant to one another, supplying each other with goods to satisfy each demand that comes along. It is fun, yet hard work indeed. That's one thing that I miss about Jay Tabor, he was a hard worker. A far harder worker than I will ever be. My hand instinctively shook at the thought of me not being able to replace Jay Tabor, yet the vastness of the city calmed me down a little bit. As I looked at the vast city, I saw a bunch of people crowded around the city center. Nearby the crowd of people, a possibly old looking car parked next to the crowd, yet it was hard to make out, it was just an oddly interesting old looking car. Then, I could barely make out the car door opening and closing before looking at the city skyline in satisfaction with myself.

(Jay's viewpoint) Me and James came out of my old rustic car, and us both pulled open the trunk. My trunk was full of Walleye, I knew people respected the taste of Walleye. Therefore, it was the perfect fish to sell in a festival. While I was relishing in the sight of the Walleye in the trunk, James asked me in a concerned voice, "What are we going to call our business?" I thought about it for about 20 seconds, changing my facial expression every second, from curiosity to sadness to happiness, every emotion ran through my body, until I had it. I then said to James in a tone of curiosity, "How about Partaceyist Fishes?" James laughed out loud, it was a thunderous laughter, it made me laugh too. I then knew at that moment that

James loved the name too. Therefore, we placed our Walleye in a cooler in the trunk and I sat in the trunk while James went next to the car with a sign that said, “Come to Partaceyist Fishes to be loved both physically and mentally!” James’s sign put a sort of heavenly uplift within my heart that sprang me into work for the business. I got my pen and paper, to record the actions of customers and myself. Me and James agreed back at the local thrift store that Partaceyist Fishes should use a simplified version of the Standard Love Valuation from *The Partaceyist Manifesto* for the business. It was not perfect, but it was a way to calculate love and respect, so I was happy to have it anyway. Meanwhile, whilst I was thinking about calculating love and respect, James was shouting, “Come to Partaceyist Fishes! Where you're always loved!”

One hour passed by, and thousands of people were passing by us, yet none were remotely interested in my business. I couldn’t understand why? Love and Walleye, what more can someone ask? Two hours passed by, and the day was fading away into dusk, yet me and James were having no luck. I was tired, thirsty, and disappointed. No one was getting a single Walleye from us and there were thousands around us. It was as if we were as invisible as a fish swimming in the distant sea. Unable to be heard nor given a thought about in the first place. It was a truly depressing feeling, yet I am a hard worker and I remained patient. James was exhausted, I could tell by the sweat on his whitening face. With eyes that faded into nothing, as if death was upon him. James was no longer shouting out the message of the sign, he was now merely laying back on the car, staring at the masses of people. Looking like he was in awe of their collective ability to ignore us. I felt as if my idea was a massive failure. I felt betrayed by *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, even when the book said that it would be a hard struggle to create the first Partaceyist business. It still felt bad that I gave James so much promise, yet he gets nothing in return.

Feeling down on my luck, I almost called off my business venture for the day when all of the sudden a woman came to my car. She said in a concerned voice, “Are you guys still open?” I gave out a happy screech, full of an exhaustedly energy baked excitement. James stood up and cheered with a gentle glee with me. The woman looked at us with a perplexed expression on her face. It didn’t bother me one bit, my first customer was finally here! The woman then said with a more concerned

tone, “I am sorry to disappoint you all, but I don’t want any Walleye. I just wanted to donate towards your business because it looked like you guys needed help.” Her statement turned my heart cold, what were me and James? Beggars on the street? Why would we ever accept a donation from such an insult?

James looked happily towards the woman and when the woman gave the money to James, he said to the customer, “How do you value the respect your donation gave to us out of 1-10?” The woman looked at James with a confused look, yet she accepted James’s request and said, “I believe that my donation is 10-10 in terms of its respect towards you. What do you think? How much respect does my donation have?” James responded by saying, “I believe that your donation is truly a 10-10 in terms of respect towards me and the business here, thank you so much.” With that, the woman left, not buying a single Walleye from us. In my disappointment, I thought all was lost. James then opened the door of my old rustic car to get a pen and paper from the front seat of the car and he gently closed it shut.

(James’s viewpoint) I was in the car, and I needed to see how much money we actually got from that woman. In what I heard about *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, donations could increase in value, if the donation was given with mutual respect. I felt mutual respect in that interaction, but I don’t know if my boss did? Anyway, I found the pen and paper and in the hot, sticky, and smelly car I wrote down the love valuations of 10-10 and 10-10. Sweating, I thought of all the different ways a Partaceyist business can calculate love and respect. There’s a lot! Yet, they are all fundamentally based on the actions of the participants of a trade. The heat of the car and my sweat made me want to think quickly about this. So, I decided to simply add the two 10s together to get 20 respect wealth. I blew a sign of relief, I found something! I saw from my boss while we were in the basement that some methods of calculating love and respect had these things called ranges or the fixed valuation. So, I then worked on the fixed valuation, which was 10, since I used 10 to base the love valuation in a measurable number. I thought about what to do with these numbers? Suddenly, sweat got into my eyes and I just wanted to quickly finish this up. So, I thought that if the fixed valuation is fixed, then the respect should try to fit into the fixed valuation to obtain a calculation.

Therefore, I decided to divide the two numbers, which was 10 divided by 20,

which equaled 0.5. Therefore, that woman gave us 50 cents within her mutual respect towards us. It was not a lot, but it was an add-on towards her 20-dollar donation towards our business. Hence, we earned 20 dollars and 50 cents on our first day. Looking at my math, I thought that maybe one day Partaceyist Fishes may use a different method to calculate love and respect or multiple methods at the same time. Although, I was tired, and I did achieve calculating the love and respect that woman gave to us. So, if I ever institutionalize a method of calculating love and respect for Partaceyist Fishes, then it should be this one for the sake of preserving fairness for that woman. For if I changed the method of calculating love and respect for Partaceyist Fishes, then that woman donation might get cheapened. No one wants that, that will hurt the reputation of Partaceyist Fishes. I then went back to work on my math for the amount of respect wealth Partaceyist Fishes had received for today a little further.

Doing the math with the collective rise and putting the donations within our expenditures fund. I found out that the 50 cents Partaceyist Fishes earned today was able to be divided in two for me and my boss to have. Although only earning 25 cents for a day is not a great achievement, so in my sweating state, I decided to rip up the paper, so that my boss wouldn't see the results. I fear that if he did see the results, then he would quit working on the Partaceyist business project. That would certainly be the end for me if that happened. Therefore, it is better to say that I lost count on the respect wealth, than to actually say what we earned as a business. I then noticed that we had no money to convert her respect into money. So, I did a shady move, I looked on the dirty floor of the old looking car and I found two quarters for me and my boss. It is not like he will ever care about where I got the quarters. Although, we did need a sort of bank entity to give us money to exchange our respect wealth for, but how? I decided to worry about that later on. What is most important right now is that I give my boss money! So, I then opened the rusty car door into the windy open air, and I closed the car door behind me.

(Jay's viewpoint) I saw James exiting my old rustic car. James then said to me in a sad tone, "I am sorry James, I lost count of the respect wealth that the woman and I measured." I looked at James with discontent and said in a stern voice, "She wasn't respectful at all! What love valuations can be placed on someone who doesn't even want to buy my Walleye!" James gave me a concerning look, like if he was a hippo

that was getting mean on me or something like that. James then said in a concerned voice, “Jay, she was respectful, she gave out her own money to us! That is proof of her respect to us!” I heard this and angrily responded, “James! She saw us as beggars on the street! What respect can be in that!” James looked to have an understanding sort of expression on his face. James then said in a raised voice, “People who give money to beggars are those who care for those beggars, isn’t that what respect is all about. We weren’t lesser people to her, we were people in need of her mutual respect towards us!” I shuddered in the cold wind, thinking of the injustice of this whole situation, yet I wanted the business to be united. Therefore, I said to James in a calmed down voice, “Ok, you didn’t even record the value of the interaction, so let’s just call it for today, do you think so to, James?” James said back to me in a defeated-like tone, “Yes, I agree. I am very tired right now.” So, me and James packed up and jumped into my old rustic car, and me and James left the festival. Whilst driving into the sunset, I could tell that James had eyes that conveyed disagreement with me, yet I was thankful that at least one person came to my business today.

(The next day) I woke up, next to my dear wife, as always, and I kissed her while she was still sleeping. I felt a renewed sense of hope that I may have Partaceyist Fishes become a success, but I just need an idea. I needed this business to be successful, so that I can proactively help myself and my dear wife have a secure and hopeful life together. I also want a refuge for the culture of hard work just like how Benchmarks Seafood was going to be. This Partaceyist business idea was it, I just knew it. So, I went downstairs to get ready for another day of business and I left my house and went onto my porch. I then tried to call James, but I noticed that I didn’t have his phone number. Yet, I found James in the most confusing spot imaginable. He was sleeping in my old rustic car? I guess he was too tired to think of going back to his house. Thinking about it, I have never seen James’s house. I wondered what his family or house would look like. Maybe he was secretly rich, living in a house full of gold and shiny metals, with a hot wife and beautiful kids. Oh, that would explain why he is so lazy all of the time because he is such a spoiled person. I opened my car door and tried to wake up James, but while I was trying to shake James, I accidentally moved the car door and the car door slammed shut.

(James viewpoint) In a land of cholesterol infested gummy bears. I ran, my heart was getting heavier and heavier. I knew the cholesterol was coming for me! So, in my agony, I threw the sword of wonders at chunky bunny the 3rd and....

Wait..., my eyes, infused from a dream like state to a gloomy reality that I lived in. A blast of light rushed through my eyes, and I heard, “Hey James, wake up, wake up, wake up.” Dizzy and shocked by the sudden transition from the dream world to the reality I lived in, I looked around in a tired state to see my boss looking at me. I really wished I was still dreaming. My boss said, “James! The Walleye are still cold, I think we should try again.” I looked at my boss and said to him in a tired voice, “Looks like you want to try again with our whole business thing. We should use our donation to our advantage. Maybe we can buy some tartar sauce for our Walleye. It can make people respect our Walleye more, which can decrease the cost on their side and increase the money on our side.” My boss looked at me with the look of magic in his eyes, it was obvious, he had an idea, which was my idea, but whatever. His success is tied to my success in this business, so I allowed him to take my idea and we got ready for another day of doing business.

I had nothing else better to do. There was nothing for me upon the horizon. All I had was this business that I co-owned with my boss. My boss? While he was driving me towards the thrift store, all I could think of was how I couldn’t get rid of my association with him as my boss. I knew that he was no longer my boss, but yet he still had the presence of a boss. It made me unable to fully embrace my newfound freedom of being a co-owner of a business. Suddenly, my temporary loss of my conception of time came up to me as the car parked and we entered into the thrift store. Walking through the alleyways, me and my boss, why do I keep calling him that? Anyway, me and my boss went through the alleyways, searching for a long 10 minutes until we found a jar of tartar sauce for 20 dollars. We grabbed it and we headed back in our furiously speedy steps towards our car. While we were walking towards the car, my boss gave out a deep exhale and said to me, “I hope this plan works, if not, then I may need to fire you.” That statement shook me to my core. I have suffered too much throughout my life. Getting fired would mark a life of misery for me. I then opened the car door and closed it while watching my boss get into the old car.

(Jay's viewpoint) I went into my old rustic car, sat down, and right as I was going to put it on drive. James said to me, "Jay, I think we should try and get a table to place the Walleye on. You being in the trunk with the Walleye could of scared people from buying?" "O-h", I splattered out to say. I then stated in an angrily voice to James, "Why didn't you say that when we are at the store? We have no more money left to spend on a table." James looked at me with a smile and said, "We can go to a garage sale to see if 50 cents could buy us a table?" It sounded brilliant, but I asked James, "Where did you find 50 cents?" James gave me a smile and said, "I found it somewhere."

After that weird conversation, I put my car on drive, and I drove to the suburbs of Grand Rapids to find any garage sales around. After a long look around, I couldn't find any garage sales anywhere. It was like trying to find a pregnant fish in an ocean, almost like a near impossible game of hide and seek. Yet, James suddenly screamed, "I found one!" It was true, James crying like the lazy boy that I knew, had found a garage sale. Therefore, in the dirt driveway, I parked my car and me and James went to the surprisingly busy garage sale. There were books, clothes, rugs, toys, everything you could dream of, there was even a table. A table that was only 50 cents. James ran right towards the table and shouted, "I need this table!" So, James got his 50 cents to buy the table. It was an old table with dust all over it. It was white, like most tables, and it was mediocrely long. I placed the table into my car in the back seat and me and James got into the car. Me and James both opened the car doors at the same time, which shocked me, yet James was a shocking individual anyway. So, I started the car, but it took a second for the engine to run, like a chicken trying to lay an egg, it took an uncomfortably long amount of time. While I was waiting for my car to start back up, in the corner of my eye, I saw a blue car park next to my car. The car door opened up and closed shut and out came a familiar looking woman.

(Samantha's viewpoint) A car was trying to start up next to me. I ignored it, seeing that life gives people lemons sometimes. I walked in my high heels, stumbling along towards the interesting garage sale. I checked out the place, it was full of junk, typical for a garage sale. Whilst looking around at the garage sale, I noticed that there was nothing special here, so as quickly as I came, I left the place. I drove

along the newly paved road towards Fortengal Seafoods. The thought of meeting the confident man behind the operation intrigued me. Once I reached Fortengal Seafoods, I noticed a shiny exterior and a huge sign next to the surprisingly broken down parking lot saying, “Welcome to Fortengal Seafoods, where hard work and supplies are king!” I parked my car and slowly walked into the behemoth that was Fortengal Seafoods. The money High Speeders invested, with their own profits, into Fortengal Seafoods in the past day has really impacted the restaurant. Every seat was full to the teeth and the place was brimming with the smells of the classic Fortengalian Walleye. I stood in the waiting line, which after an hour of waiting, I started to get impatient. So, I asked the worker up front if I could speak to Kent Fortengal. She said back to me, “Are you kidding me? Mr. Fortengal doesn’t talk to low brow people like you. You should apologize right now!” Good gracious, people here are snotty. It is a fancy restaurant, but seriously. I am not that low brow. That is what I thought although, I said nothing in response to the worker up front. I simply wanted a meal, not a debacle. Suddenly, the office door opened up and closed shut to reveal a handsome man indeed.

(Kent’s viewpoint) My restaurant was so beautiful. My employees were running place to place, serving the customers like how all good businesses should be. I saw in the kitchen window supplies galore. The money those supplies of Walleye could make ringed like bells of jolly in my ears. I couldn’t be more thankful for Fred Fortengal, my older brother, for temporarily giving me the position of CEO while he was on vacation. While I was relishing my hard work for this restaurant, I heard a loud call directed to me. It sounded like, “Kent! Kent, we need to talk!” I was curious in the calling, so I walked up in confidence towards the noise. When I came to the noise, I noticed that it was being created by a woman. She looked at me with an obvious affectionate glance. It was disgusting, I was never into girls like that. She then said to me, “Mr. Fortengal, Your staff are being rude to me. Shouldn’t you fire them?” Her statement enraged me. My staff at Fortengal Seafoods are hard workers. Hard workers endure work by doing their duty towards the customers like this spoiled lady. How could such accusations be placed on my staff? My staff was once my former boss’s staff, he was nice enough to allow them to keep their jobs by selling off his business. They have endured everything, from crisis to crisis, no emotional slander will ever stop my company from protecting my employees.

So, I said to the woman, “Miss, you were rude to my employee here, work at Fortengal Seafoods can be a lot sometimes, so it is only natural that my employees may come across as rude to some. Although, since you are a customer here, it is your duty to obey my employees. So, leave or pay for your seat.” The lady still gave me a look of that awful magic in someone’s eyes. She then glanced at me, as if she was looking for opportunities and then she dramatically kissed me on the lips. The texture felt like if a ball of spaghetti fell onto a hopeless monkey and the wetness of that spaghetti curled up the hairs of the monkey, creating pockets of wet hair. In layman’s terms, this kiss felt like wet hair. It was beyond disgusting, I honestly thought kisses were better than this. Yet, as soon as it happened, it thankfully stopped. In the midst of the gasping of my customers, the woman then grabbed me by the arm and whispered in my ear, “My name is Samantha Demandia, and I request a seat.” What a fitting name indeed, Samantha Demandia. I had to kick her out, but if I did, then my customers may get angry. Business is all about serving your customers. So, I decided to allow Samantha to take a seat at my precious restaurant. Embarrassed and upset, I decided to walk back into my office room, and I quickly opened and closed my office door, to escape from the madness of Samantha Demandia.

(Samantha's viewpoint) Seeing Kent’s tuxedo jiggle and wiggle around in such a cool fashion was a sight to see. Kent was definitely a cool guy indeed. Yet, I couldn’t get out of my head of how similar Kent’s attitude was to Jay’s attitude, a former client of mine and the former owner of the building. It was as if they both had a force that directed their path within the business, or I am just going crazy. I don’t know, I just find it interesting that they share similarities as business owners. Anyway, I looked around at the business and I saw an employee with his back leaning towards me. He then began to walk towards me, and his walk was weak in nature, and he looked exhausted beyond comprehension. The employee came to me and said in a quiet, yet raspy voice, “What do you want to order miss?” I gave a shocked expression at the employee, it looked like he needed a break, yet he was trying to serve me something. It was very sad, yet there was nothing I could do about it. As if I was only a viewer of a horror movie, I could only sit and watch as my waiter suffered. So, I had no choice but to respond back to the employee in a voice that conveyed a slight sense of hopelessness, “I want the Fortengalian

Walleye, please.” The employee’s face looked unreachable with an unexacting expression of sorrow. After I gave my order, the employee limped his way towards the kitchen and I watched him limp away from my seat, horrified. This restaurant had an exterior of beauty, but it had an interior of horror and hardship. Sitting at my table, I saw the beautiful lights and displays of the restaurant, yet I could see the suffering workers all around me. Forfeiting life, to serve others who have not forfeited life yet. It just felt as if a better way was possible. The systematics of the restaurant just felt out of place with the beautiful exterior of the restaurant.

After 30 minutes of looking in awe of the contradictions of the restaurant, my food was ready. The tired employee came to me and let out a loud gasp when he placed down my fish. The Fortengalian Walleye was a beautiful fish, yet a product was all that it was. So, for my curiosity I asked the employee in a tone of curiosity, “Hey, how long do you work per day?” He responded, “Miss, I work 14 hours per day, thank you for your concern.” He then asked me for the money for the Fortengalian Walleye, I grabbed my purse and gave him 50 dollars, the price of the dish. He then grabbed the money with a gentle loose grip and said in a tired voice, “Thank you.” Then, the employee limped away into the hallway of the kitchen to serve some more people for the long day. I then looked back at my plate, I saw the Fortengalian Walleye, which was a full fish stuffed with freshly cut mashed potatoes.

It was really good, the taste felt like a wave of soft slow moving wine covered every ounce of my mouth. It was as if I was drowning in wine, too drunk to be aware of my issues. A taste so wonderful that I knew the labor put into it was harsh and grueling. I consumed that Walleye faster than Sonic consuming a fabulous chilly cheese hot dog. Although soon it was gone, and my experience was up. I quietly left my seat and left the restaurant. I headed back into my car, walking away from the restaurant with a slow stepping motion, reflective of my transient thoughts about the restaurant that Kent owns. I drove out of the surprisingly poorly maintained parking lot and decided to drive back to my work, the High Speeders HQ. After a few minutes, while I was driving along a nicely paved road, I noticed a sign that said, “Come to Partaceyist Fishes, where respect to us means a fish for you!” I know I just ate not so long ago, but I was curious of what they meant by love? What did love have to do with fish? Do I need to kiss a fish to get a fish?

That's kind of disgusting. Yet, my curiosity got the better of me and I drove into a parking lot next to the local thrift store. When I parked my beautiful blue car, I noticed a man opening his car door and closing it, looking at me with a terrifyingly directive sense of glee in his eyes.

(Jay's viewpoint) I thought James's idea of placing the sign next to a highway was stupendous because no one would notice a sign driving 60 down the road. Yet, James had proven me wrong, I knew that when I glanced at my first customer. I was transfixed in the happiness of my hard work paying off. Full of glee, I knew I needed to meet my first customer and see what he or she thought of my business. Yet, when I stood there in the parking lot of the thrift store, I felt only confusion and anger in me. That was because the car quickly turned around and bolted away from my business. Again, the disrespect of others hits me hard. After the car left, a lingering thought came into the head, what can turn death into fortune? It felt that it was as if the car died by not experiencing my business and because of that, fortune was not given to the one driving that car. Looking at the last glimpses of that blue car, I stood there sad, yet even more mournful than sad. It was a surreal experience indeed, but the work must be done.

After that whole ordeal, I went to James, who was behind my old rustic car, counting the Walleye in my trunk and placing the Walleye on the mediocrely long table, covered in a thin layer of ice. He was counting the Walleye so that my business was sure to have enough tartar sauce for the Walleye within this sweet unprofitable business. Yet, James is respecting the business, so in respect to the goal of the business I asked James, "James, rate how respectful your action right now is towards the business out of 1-10." James responded in a calmed voice, "I will rate my action 9-10. But Jay, what will you rate my action's respect to the business?" I responded back in a sarcastic voice, "It is a 5-10 for you, which means that, 20 divided by 14, oh, it is about \$1.4 for the total money generated from your respect to the business, thus we both earned about 70 cents for each of us in payment for your action of counting." James looked at me and said, "Jay, are you ok? It sounds like you're distressed about something." I knew I was and in a snarky voice I said, "Yeah, a customer came by, but that customer just bolted out before even trying out the Walleye." James looked at me with his traditional understanding look in his eyes and said, "It sounds like you scared the customer

off. You are a scary person after all.” I am scary? What craziness is that? I then asked James, “What makes me so scary? All I ever do is help you?”

James gave an expression that bore a resemblance to a drunk walrus, his teeth showing, his eyes trodden through his soul-filled expression on his face. Then, James simply moved on and restarted his counting of the Walleye. He was obviously hiding something from me with that look on his face, but I ignored it. It was not like he was special in any way. I am the architect of the business, he is just a freelancer of the business. After the fog of emotions died down from the conversation I had with James, I saw another car coming towards us. So, I waved at the car to get its attention like a fish trying to get the attention of a female. It worked! The car was parked next to my old rustic car. The sound of the car parking was magical to my ears. A blanket of silence came for a few seconds and then out came a man, who left his car door wide open. The man was an average age; short, bearded, and had sunglasses. He was a guy, but to me he was a customer. Hopefully he is a hungry one because he is going to get some Walleye today. Although, before I could come to the guy, James ran up to him, in a gleeful fashion. James then said to him in a gleeful tone, “Sir, do you want Walleye, we sell the freshest Walleye around!” The man said to James in a confused and concerned voice, “Sir, I hate to admit it, but the thrift store is right over there. What makes me want to buy your Walleye over the Walleye at the thrift store?” James looked at him with a face of odd confidence and he quickly ran towards my old rustic car and opened my old rustic car door. I saw that James got his phone and paperwork out of my old rustic car, and he then closed my old rustic car door.

(James’s viewpoint) I got my phone, but I am so scared right now. This moment will make or break my newfound security in life. So, I am taking a leap of faith, not knowing what could happen, yet I am being forced by myself to push on into the mysterious unknown. I showed the man my paperwork with my love valuations, and I said, “Here at Partaceyist Fishes, you can respect us and get a fish. Respect here is in the form of...” I actually didn’t know what type of respect we wanted here. It sounds odd, but it was a very important detail. I stumbled around, unable to stomach my failure to finish my sentence. Then, the man said in a confused voice, “What respect could I do then to get a fish?” I had no idea at all. So, I stood there quietly, yet hopeless. Suddenly, my boss shouted in confidence, “We—ask

that—.....” My boss then looked to lose his confident demeanor and I noticed he began to become more stumped in his words when he started to say, “uhm.... I honestly don’t know how to answer that question.” The man looked at me and my boss with a shocked expression, like how a ground hog looks at a lawn mower, and said, “Well, if I don’t know how to pay, then I simply won’t pay. Good luck on your business venture.”

The man then turned around and I felt a wave of sober sadness overcome me. He got into his car and just left. Without saying bye or anything like that. He just left me and my boss with a question we could not answer and left. I felt defeated. It was a terrible feeling to be so unsuccessful and feel dumb as well. I am sure my boss felt it too, but my mind pondered at the question the man asked us. What respect can I do then to get a fish? While walking back to my station on the table, I pondered this question. What respect can I do then to get a fish? What respect can I do? Then to get a fish? Wait just a minute, what respect can I do? That’s like saying to the customer that they need to help the business out to get a fish. That’s the type of respect that we need to use! We can have the customers be like the workers! Besides, if they increase their respect to the business, then their fish becomes cheaper! This is the idea! This is the one! I need to talk to my boss about this, now!

Chapter 3

The Dispute

I ran with a joyous gleeful stride towards my boss. My legs were unhinged by the drag of the air whilst I ran towards my boss. My boss was just about to enter our car when I came to him and said, “Hey Jay, I think I may have found a solution to the man’s question.” My boss responded to me while giving me an intrigued glance at me, “What are you thinking James?” I, of course, responded back to my boss since his intrigued glance at me gave me a sense of fear towards him and I wanted to help our business out. So, I responded in a limberly tone to my boss, “I propose that we can have customers help us with the business. In exchange for this, we can decrease their costs for getting Walleye for their actions towards helping our business. This can help us increase respect in our business, increasing the pay for everyone, decreasing the costs for the customers, and giving us motivated workers that can help us with worker shortage issues.” My boss looked at me and said to me in a concerned tone, “That’s all-good James, but what will motivate customers? The ones me and you serve for, to work in the business.” I knew that this question was a hard one. Laying on the rustic car, I thought hard about this question. Thinking like a dolphin looking at a bouncy ball, I tried to come up with an answer to my boss’s question. Then, it came to me, like a cow suddenly stopping to eat at a patch of grass, it came to me. The customers are compensated while they help with the business by the decrease in the cost of the product we give to them. Hence, price becomes determined by respect. It is what we need in our business to move away from supply and demand, like what is talked about in *The Partaceyist Manifesto*.

So, I gave my answer to my boss, “Jay, the customers are compensated by having their costs for our Walleye decrease. Each customer could have the opportunity to help out with the business and be rewarded based on the mutual respect developed

by them towards our business.” My boss looked at me with a glance of stubborn concern and said to me in a forceful, direct tone, “James, with all due respect, businesses should serve their customers, not let their customers work for their own experience. It is a good strategy, but it is not moral, so it won’t work.” I totally disagreed with my boss’s statement because when I was a worker in Benchmarks Seafood, I felt a sense of something was off within the business. Although, something was blocking this possibility of bettering the conditions of the worker-customer relationship. Yet, I still feared my former boss, which was because I still felt that foreboding sense of something in him. Although, I am a co-owner of Partaceyist Fishes, so I have power now. Although, without my boss I would be unable to continue the business. I needed my boss’s mediocre wealth because I had nothing. My boss looked at me with disappointment in his eyes, like how a failed firework disappoints a whole crowd. He then opened his car door and slammed it shut.

(Jay’s viewpoint) James didn’t get it. Sitting in the car, disappointed in James and in my own business, I felt that this business was losing its focus on hard work. Customers becoming workers to decrease their costs? That’s totally against the concept of valorous hard work and service towards customers, the purpose of a great business. I cannot accept James answer to that man’s question. Yet, currently my business had has no customers at all. The Walleye can only last for so long until it expires. Although, the message of my business, the purpose of my business will not be compromised. I can stand by that, no matter if I get customers or not. Suddenly, James knocked on my car door, pointing at another car coming towards us. It was a customer! I was overwhelmed by a sense of shock and excitement. So, I thoughtlessly whipped the door open, which destroyed my car door. Yet, I didn’t care, what matters is having a customer for Partaceyist Fishes! So, I went to greet the possible customers. Although, before I could even react, James ran towards the car and the car parked next to James. James talked to the person next to the car. It looked like the person had a family with him.

James was talking with the guy for a long time. I stood there on the parking lot, confused and concerned about what James may be saying. I didn’t want to scare my customers away, so I just walked away, hoping that the customer may stay. I sat on a flimsy chair next to the white mediocely long table, filled to the brim with

Walleye. The smell of which gave me a sense of an oceanic experience, beyond my comprehension. It was comforting to stay in my state of rest, waiting for the possibility of the customer to come to my business. Yet, a thought still lingered in my head, what can turn death into fortune? It was a random thought, yet I cared for my dear wife and when she said that to me, I felt a power that has gripped me ever since. So, this thought lingered in my head, and I couldn't think of an answer to it. Although, I had an idea, hard work, right? One can save someone from death and then what was going to become a tragedy instead becomes a fortune. It sounded right, so I settled my thoughts to focus on my work, and I sat there looking at the Walleye, waiting for the sweet money to come towards me.

After what felt like an hour, James came around my old rustic car with the customer. As if it was an action movie, James was walking with a confident stride. Swinging his legs and hips like if he was a Hollywood superstar. When I noticed James' confidence in his walk, I knew he did something against my wishes. The customer and James then went up next to the mediocre table and the customer said to me, "Hi, my name is Jared, I was told that you would allow me to help your business out in exchange for cheaper Walleye. I am a landlord, so I was thinking that I could allow you guys to rent out a small urban cabin that I own. In exchange, I expect to get a deal of cheap Walleye for a prolonged period of time, is that possible?"

When I heard the man, I thought that he was crazy or was joking around. How can someone just give us a building to place our business in? It made no sense to me at all. Yet, I couldn't run a business entirely from an old rustic car, especially an old rustic car with only three doors intact. So, I reluctantly said to Jared, "I accept your gift to my business, thank you. What do you rate your gift out of 1-10? Jared quickly blurted out to me, "How about rating my gift out of 1-100?" Like a tiger in a pen, I felt that I was in a trap, I wanted to say no because the customer was dictating the business's interpretation of the price, yet I was in no position to say no to such a deal. Therefore, I said to Jared in a defeated voice, "Fine, you can rate your gift out of 1-100." In a snap of a second after I finished what I said, Jared said in a slight gleeful tone, "It feels like to me that my gift is a 90-100." This whole thing felt so weird to me. I am used to the customer obeying the business, not the business and customer not obeying each other. Yet, somehow Jared wanted to help

my business. Although, when Jared and I had a gap in this conversation of ours, James blurted out at me and said, “What do you mean by my business?”

James looked at me with a sheer sense of anger and betrayal in his weak looking eyes. I needed to say something to James or Jared may reconsider his proposal. So, I said in a deeply confident voice, “Yes James, Partaceyist Fishes was my idea, since I am the one who thought of making a Partaceyist business, not you.” Jared looked quiet as me and James stared at each other with a look that reminded me of a car engine trying to start up, but it's exhaust just gets louder and louder. Suddenly, James shouted at me saying, “This business is mine too! Jay, you promised that to me! How could you assert that this business is all yours! Have you even read *The Partaceyist Manifesto*!” I got even more angry by James’s shouting demeanor. His angry posturing, his disobeying of my wishes, and his reluctance to accept my vision for the business made me lose the courage to respect James anymore. I shouted as loud as a firework blowing up a nuclear bomb, “I am the hardworking man that built this business! James! You are nothing, but a freelancer to me!” James looked at me with discontent and disgust, like I cared at this point. James then said in a commanding, yet pathetic voice, “I may not be the most hardworking man around here but look at what you done. Nothing! I was the one that allowed us to be able to have a table and tartar sauce! You simply sit around, drive, and talk. In my view, I am the founder of Partaceyist Fishes! Not you!” Anger began to fill my veins, like how a pot of soup can boil into a vicious gas, which was my blood right now. How dare James disrespect my hard work that I put into Partaceyist Fishes!

I then splattered at James with a vicious hot and gooey spit and said, “You have disrespected your service to the customers, the hard work of my business, and the purpose of the business that I created!” James responded in a mean tone, “Jay...! The purpose of our business is to give us another chance for survival in this harsh world! It is not of hard work, you tried that, and Benchmarks Seafood died. If you don’t stop--” Jared, in a quick fashion, covered James’s mouth. Jared then glared at me with a glance of disappointment in his eyes. His eyes turned my boiled up anger into fear. Fear that I may of done something very bad indeed. Jared then said to me, “Sir, I should go, it looks like I had a misguided first impression of this business. I fear that my presence here will rip this business apart.” Jared then walked away like a horse without a rider, unpredictably moving around the parking lot, looking

like he was still contemplating helping us or not. That was, until he drove away from the parking lot for good. Me and James were transfixed on Jared's fleeing movements from us.

While looking at Jared's car driving away from the parking lot, I realized that my arguing with James had made us lose another customer. James then looked at me with a glare in his eyes of angrily discontent. He then said to me, "Jay, this is all your fault. Look at what your hard work has done for us, isn't it just amazing?" I gave a menacing glance at James, who was always the one to lazily attack people when they were at their weakest point. I so wanted to fire James, yet I knew that will mark the end of my business and of my business career as well. I cannot deny that he has been helpful to me in creating ideas for the business, even though he thought of those ideas with very little effort. So, for my own benefit, I asked James in a calmed down voice, "James, let's go in the car and call it for a day. As of right now, you and I are both failures." James gave me a fiery grumpy look, yet he had a layer of acceptance in his eyes. I didn't know how long that acceptance would last, but for now I had calmed down the storm. Me and James decided to pack our things up and go into my old rustic car. I packed up the smelly Walleye and the full jug of tartar sauce into the trunk of my car and James packed up the mediocredly long white table. I then went into my now nonexistent doorway in my car, in the front seat, and James opened the car door on the other end of the front of my car. James then closed the door in a dramatic fashion.

(James's viewpoint) I was sitting in my seat, thinking about what just happened. I am a failure? No—, well yes actually, but no I can't be a failure. I did so much for our business. Yet, I am so desperate in life that I am forced to hang out with my former boss to be able to survive in this harsh world. Yeah, I am a failure, but what even is failure? Is my failure in arguing with my former boss? If that's it, then is that really failure on my part or failure for my former boss's fault. I kept thinking of this while my boss started the car. The car made an old rickety sound, like an old man trying to cough. Until suddenly, the car roared into life, and we went on our way towards my boss's house. Whilst driving out of the parking lot, my boss said to me in a demanding confused tone, "Hey James, where do you live?" His question felt misplaced to me, which gave me a perplexity within me like a hyena trying out a ballerina dance. I didn't know how to respond to such a question.

Therefore, I decided to ask my boss a question, “Jay, why do you ask about where I live?” My boss gave me a stern look and said to me, “I believe you may want to go back to your family and friends, you have been living with me for a few days now.” I gave my boss a look of mixed determination and sadness and said, “Jay, I don’t have family or friends.” My boss seemed to be uncomfortable by my response and he became as quiet as a hummingbird would be. In the awkward silence within the car, with the cold wind beginning to blow aggressively through my face as the wind entered through the once attached door. I thought about respect in a Partaceyist business. Specifically, respect within our Partaceyist business. I knew from my personal experience at Benchmarks Seafood that a business without respect is a business of only hardship and misery. A miserable worker cannot serve themselves in goodness, let alone serve another with goodness.

My misery at Benchmarks Seafood showed me that when I am miserable, the business will just move on. As if the business didn’t care about respect to its workers at all. It may take hard work to make a business, but it takes respect to make a commitment towards a business. I looked at my boss’s eyes while he was driving, those were the eyes of a man that had commitment, yet somehow something seemed off. It is like how you search on YouTube for a long time and then you experience the woods. There is this feeling of something being off. I felt this same feeling looking into the eyes of my former boss. Luckily, he didn’t notice me looking into his eyes since he was so focused on driving back to his home. Yet, I needed to help my boss out. If he felt off, maybe it is because he is not fine. I needed him to be fine, for without my boss, I couldn’t run the business, since he knows all the best ways to financially keep a business stable. This business thing must still go on for not just my sake, but for my boss’s sake too.

Thus, I asked my boss a question, “Hey Jay, about hard work, why do you value hard work so much?” My boss looked at me with a grin within the aggressive blowing winds in the car. His relatively nice demeanor faded away like melting sea ice and transformed into a slightly meaner style of expression. He then said to me, “James, to me hard work is what makes people special. Hard work gives me meaning to life. Without hard work, life is meaningless. Think about death, when someone dies, did they use hard work to die, or did they not use hard work to die?” Jeez, my boss was a madman, death and hard work, what connection does these

two things have? In the midst of the increasingly unbearable cold wind, I said to my boss in a slightly conforming tone, “Sir, I don’t know.” My boss then gave out a misplaced smile and said to me, “You see, you can’t think of anything because death is the definition of meaninglessness, it is not hard to die.” Although I understood my boss’s point, I felt a sort of tension inside of me from his statement, that I had to let out.

I said to my boss in a tone that sounded like a displeased seal stepping on nails, “Jay, I have worked at Benchmarks Seafood before, and I have to admit that hard work has no purpose associated with it. I worked so incredibly hard at Benchmarks Seafood, yet I feel no personal connection or personal development from working at Benchmarks Seafood. I was working too much to experience meaning and life. Hard work is not meaningful, hard work is the opposite, it is the destroyer of meaning in life. Without hard work, one can calm down and develop into the person they want to be.” My boss gave me a glance of displeasure. It was clear that he didn’t like what I had to say. Yet, I felt so relieved to say what I truly felt about my experience at Benchmarks Seafood at my former boss. Jay loosened his grip on the wheel and said to me in a grumpy grandpa-like voice, “James, work is work, a job is a job, it doesn’t matter what emotions you think about it. What matters is that the job must get done by any means necessary. Meaning in work is derived from the achievement of enduring another day of work. Workers are supposed to service the customer’s desires because it is the customer that pays. Workers get paid, so they can endure the suffering and in exchange they get meaning in their life.” I looked at my boss with discontent as powerful as a whale’s roar. The icy cold wind inside the car got even colder and more powerful. The cold wind inside the car swayed me and my boss from side to side. Yet, I couldn’t stop looking at my boss with my eyes of discontent. I was still confident that hard work is not all that it was chucked up to be. So, I angrily responded back at my boss, “Jay! Meaning in work is not derived from endurance! If that was true, then do you feel like work today was meaningful?”

My boss stared at me and said in a sternly aggressive voice, “We didn’t serve anyone today, James! We failed! Your ideas have all failed! Tell me James, do you feel that today was successful?” I thought about what my boss said to me and yes. Today was successful to me because we had people come to our business. Any

business in an old rusty car would be viewed as hillbillies trying to sell illegal stuff or something. We were successful, even if we had no sales throughout our business endeavor. We failed to serve our customers, yet I still felt a sense of achievement in the fact that I learned more about a Partaceyist business than ever before.

Therefore, I said in a loud assertive voice to overcome the loud icy wind, “Jay! We are successful and we learned more about Partaceyism today! We even had people come to us!” My boss looked at me, shaking his head at me.

He then said to me in a strikingly loud shout, “James!!! Success is not about you or me. Success is about money and Partaceyist Fishes have none! How are we going to get more supplies to receive more customers! We are done for!” Suddenly, the car moved crazily out of control, and I screamed, “Ahhhhhhhhh!!!!” My boss yelled at me, “Calm down you clown!!! Grow up!!” The car stabilized in a sudden jolt of force. It was dreadful, yet my mind was thrashed by my boss’s comment to me. Grow up? What is it with people contributing a lack of meaning in work to mean growing up? It felt like my boss was trying to force an opinion onto me that he didn’t want nor agreed with. Last that I heard, only a child would be a fool enough to change everything about themselves to satisfy someone else’s opinion about them. My boss was being disturbingly disgusting in his words and his intent was as clear as a lonely wedding cake. So, amid the icy wind, I battled my way to turn my head away from the endlessly mean looking face staring at me and occasionally back at the road. I instead looked out into the landscape, and I could see our sign, but only for a glimpse. In a state of anger, I didn’t want to help my boss at all. That included helping him with our business’s sign. I knew the road commission or volunteers would throw it away eventually. So, I didn’t tell my boss to pick up our sign, he was too deep into his anguish to think about such trivial things.

I expected my boss to lash out at me, yet to my surprise, he simply ceased to talk to me. I looked out into the distance, and I saw the scenery change from suburbia to downtown. Whilst looking at the sublime scenery, I thought to myself about my boss’s comments to me. Thinking and wondering were all playing their delicate dance inside my head. I wondered with a thrust that reminded me of those lights in teleportation within Si-fi movies. After relaxing in the wonders of thought, I came across what my boss said to me about hard work and service. I was serving

customers at Benchmarks Seafood, yet it felt like a burden rather than a gift. I then thought about the amount of service I did for Benchmarks Seafood, it was a lot. The days there felt as if they were all one. The pain in my muscles from then still lingered on while I thought about it. It was a rough time with nothing to show for it. My money was all spent on buying food, since the company policy was to not give out free meals to workers. Service is also such a vague thing to base worth on. Is service helping a dog get out from the cold icy water or is service working until your muscles give way? I think my boss should know this question, since he has built his entire business life around service. Yet, I had a deep feeling that he didn't know the answer to this essential question. Yet, my boss needed to know this, not for my sake, but for our future business's sake. Without answering this question, we can never escape the chains of service under the customer.

Therefore, I decided to slowly lift my hand towards my boss while he was driving. I wanted to steal my boss's wallet, so I could show him how easily one can lose their compensation for hard work. This is because no compensation can replace the suffering of workers under the yoke of hard work and obedient servitude. Hard work is only something that must be prevented, not preserved. If my boss could be shocked, then maybe he may properly listen to my essential question for him? So, as my hand came closer to my boss's pocket, I felt a sharp sense of fear bubbling inside me, like how a pot of chilly cheese would boil up in a 400 degree stove. My mind told me to back down or I will regret it. Yet, I wanted to help my boss see my story, my argument. So, my hand continued its long journey towards my boss's pocket. I held my breath as I neared my boss's pocket and I gently swindled my hand into my boss's soft pocket. I gently pulled out a mediocre black wallet out of my boss's pocket. Once his wallet was out of his pocket, I quickly placed his wallet in my pocket with ease. My boss didn't notice a thing, he was so fixated on driving and the powerful icy cold winds within the car blanketed the sounds of my movements. It was too perfect of a move, that I had to say something to my boss, or he may not even know what I did.

So, I said to my boss my essential question in a subtle tone of intrigue, "Hey Jay, about hard work and service, how much hard work would you qualify as adequate service to a customer?" My boss turned his head, which freaked me out, who was looking at the road! The car became unstable, as if it wasn't already unstable. My

boss's devious stare glued right into my eyes. I felt sharply intoxicated by his oppressive presence. Then, my boss shouted in a rough angrily voice, "That's it James, I had enough of you! Get out!" The old rustic car suddenly gave out a loud screeching sound as if an ostrich was screaming out for mercy. My body jolted itself and I felt a huge tug on me as my gut was squeezed by my seat belt.

Exhausted and shocked, I heard my boss scream at me, "I mean it! Get out and find another job!" The unbearable screaming and pain forced me to open the car door and limp out of the old rustic car. I hit the cold and harsh concrete street. It was painful, yet not as painful as the pain my boss gave to me. In my broken state, I saw a blue car that parked next to our car. It looked nice, barely in my sight, but it was nicer than my boss's car and attitude. So, my focus shifted towards that beautiful blue car. Right when my boss was about to close that old rustic car door, the door to the blue car opened and then quickly closed shut.

(Samantha's viewpoint) I looked up at High Speeders HQ. The day was turning into a sharp dusky atmosphere. I could feel the atmosphere getting colder around me. I was going to head back home after my work, but whilst driving I heard of Kent Fortengal's surprise visit to High Speeders HQ on my radio. I thought whilst listening to my radio talk host about the employee I talked to during my lunch. He was suffering and I felt that Kent Fortengal didn't know about his suffering.

Therefore, I wanted to make sure that Kent Fortengal knew about the struggles of his own employee, so that he could help him. So, compelled by my sense of justice, I walked into High Speeders HQ with a confident stride. While I walked into High Speeders HQ, I thought about my reasoning for trying to help out Kent's business. I wanted Kent to be better than Jay Tabor. I didn't want him to fail to get more workers by over working them. If that employee was truly overworked, then Kent must know about it. It is for his betterment and mine too. Besides, a handsome guy like Kent needs a considerate woman like me. I walked into the hallway where my office is located and at the end of the hallway, I saw Kent! His defined chin, his fancy tuxedo, his everything was beholden to my eyes. Kent was walking in the hallway, and I needed to stop him.

Therefore, I shouted at Kent, "Hi Kent, remember me?!" Kent then partially turned his head at me and showed a look that looked to be a mix of curiosity and confidence. Wow!? Kent stopped his elegant striding, and I ran towards him. In my

galloping of joyous thunder, nothing matters to me. I simply wanted to get to Kent. After what felt like a light year, I grabbed Kent's arm. Kent stared at me with confusion in his eyes as I spun him around. I needed to get his attention, so that I could tell him about the issue within his business. After what felt as long as a cat turning its head, Kent finally glanced at me with a grace so overwhelming and said, "Samantha, what on Earth are you doing?" I looked at Kent with courage and will, trying to outcompete his own confidence within him. I then mustered the courage to say to Kent, "Kent, there is something I must tell you." Kent then said back to me, "And what would that be exactly?" I investigated his confidence radiating within his eyes and I said in a gentle voice, "While I was being served at your restaurant, one of your employees committed to me about how over worked he was. I was wondering if you knew about his situation?"

Kent gave me a stare and he looked at me with an upset look on his face. He then said to me with a shocking tone of enthusiasm, "Samantha, this is a good thing! It upsets me when people disrespect other people's hard work. My employees work hard to receive meaning within my company. Fortengal Seafoods is a community, not a dictatorship." I heard Kent's statement, and I felt a semblance of disagreement. I knew that his employee was not liking his current situation, I could easily tell when I saw the employee. Yet, Kent did not care about that? It felt like a betrayal to me. I was doing this for Kent. Yet, Kent was blaming me for promoting sadness when there was happiness? What is even happening?! I needed to say something to Kent, so I said to Kent in a cautioning voice, "Kent, I saw that employee, he was limping and leaning in ways that shows that he needs rest and care. Kent, you need to give him some rest!" Kent looked at me with a fading sense of concern appearing in his eyes like how a bear looks at you but walks away due to disinterest. Kent then said to me in a reaffirming voice, "Samantha, if you care about this employee, then you should let him be. He is serving his community. In this regard, it is only natural that he will suffer for the community. It is just life, deal with it, Samantha."

I knew when thinking about what Kent had to say that I couldn't agree with it. Why should one not get rest? Is it because that is the way it just is? No, I refuse this logic. I cannot accept that this employee is condemned to suffering for the sake of that is just the job he is doing. If that is that case, then help him! Kent was

obviously avoiding to help him. It then came to me, a truly hardworking man would help the employee, not try to make excuses. Suddenly, I slightly changed my facial expression from one of joy to one of distaste for Kent. I began to slowly feel that my love for Kent faded away like wet paint running down a wall. I was thick in love, but now my love for Kent was beginning to start thinning out. If Kent didn't want to help the employee, then I will just have to help the employee myself. Therefore, I said to Kent in an angrily upset voice, "Fine, go to wherever you were going towards. I hope you have a great day, farewell Kent." I then lifted my heavy legs and left Kent. While I was walking towards the end of the hallway, I saw Kent turn away from me and he opened a door and gently closed it behind him.

(Kent's viewpoint) Why is Samantha so focused on my own employee? He works at my company because he wants to do hard work. It is not a secret that Fortengal Seafoods is a paradise of hard working culture. It is a privilege to experience hard work, it is not something to be ashamed of. Samantha should just accept that in this world, there are losers and winners and those that work are ultimately winners in this world. I quietly said, "Augh" whilst entering the head meeting room of High Speeders HQ. I saw the vice chairman of High Speeders, looking at me with content within his eyes. I had a meeting with the vice chairman because he asked me that he had a special plan for me and my business. I am so excited about this possible business prospect. In fact, I was so excited that Samantha's unhinged talk with me in the hallway faded from my mind as I looked at the vice chairman of High Speeders. The vice chairman of High Speeders then said to me in a calm voice, "Hi Kent, welcome to High Speeders HQ, please sit down. I want to talk to you about something important." In an awe of curiosity, I sat down in a soft chair, and I listened to what the vice chairman had to say to me. The vice chairman of High Speeders sat down at the same time as I did and he then said to me with a hint of enthusiasm, "Kent, I have a business proposal to you. What if Fortengal Seafoods merged with High Speeders? Think about it, Kent. Money will pour right into your pockets, and everyone will become rich at Fortengal Seafoods!"

Listening to the vice chairman, I internally wanted to agree to his proposal of merging my business with his. Yet, my business is far too small in comparison to High Speeders. I would lose the control over the message and goal of Fortengal Seafoods if Fortengal Seafoods merged with the far larger High Speeders. If

Fortengal Seafoods merged with High Speeders, then the hard working culture I developed within the business may be at risk. I simply couldn't risk that, no matter how much money I may receive. For me, Fortengal Seafoods is not about the money, it is about the hard work that me and my employees dedicated to others. With tension brewing in my eyes, I looked at the vice chairman of High Speeders with a developing concerned glance. I could tell he knew my opinion about his proposed deal. I responded back at the vice chairman of High Speeders in a confident tone, "I am thankful of your concern for my business, yet at Fortengal Seafoods, we serve customers first and merging Fortengal Seafoods with High Speeders will hinder our ability to promote our message and goal as a business to our customers. Thank you for your time, sir."

The vice chairman looked at me with an understanding look of disappointment in his eyes. Looking at the situation, I knew that the deal was over. As I began to stand up from my comfy chair, a blue car caught my eye. I noticed that blue car was coming to an intersection. I saw that car from the window next to the vice chairman of High Speeders. That blue car reminded me of someone, yet I couldn't think of anyone in particular. Full of wonder and curiosity, I looked more in-depth at that blue car, and I noticed that the stop light at the intersection was red. Yet, that blue car was still driving at full speed towards the intersection. I didn't feel so good about what could happen to that car, so I ran towards the window. I ignored the concerns and noises of the vice chairman. All that I wanted in the moment was to do the hard work of warning that car like a true man. Thus, I tried to open the window, but the window was locked. Struggling to open the window, I felt a sense of fear rushing through my veins.

Once I knew that the window would not open by conventional means, I had no choice but to simply stand there, hopelessly looking at the blue car through the window. Waiting for whatever fate may come to that blue car. I then saw the blue car speeding right through the red light and an old looking rustic car rushed right through the intersection while the blue car was running the red light. Then, all of the sudden I heard a loud noise that sounded like a cannonball nose diving. I watched in horror as the blue car spun around crazily and the front of the blue car, crushed by the force of the impact, went under the car. The impact created a huge indentation on the front of the blue car. The old rustic car had its front damaged to

a degree of a damaged orange falling from a decaying tree. Whilst watching the crash unfold, my hand instinctively shook and I cried out a screeching, “Noooooo!!!” Trapped in the building, unable to help, I felt like a failure looking at the unfolding destruction, unable to do anything helpful to those in need. Suddenly, I saw the right front door of the old rustic car in midair open up. Out came a man that I couldn’t make out, due to the distance between me and this man. The car door then quickly shut back up, probably from the pressure of the wind on the car door.

(Jay’s viewpoint) In midair, I felt as if I was a bird flying into the sky. It was a freeing feeling, although I anticipated that my skin would eventually crash back into the rough hardness of the concrete road. The blue car next to me was falling to the concrete, just like me. The icy wind covered my skin in an icy layer. I felt that the wind will be protection for me when I land. Although, once I landed onto the concrete, I felt a lingering pain as my arm rubbed against the stiff concrete of the road. I tried to place my arm onto the brunt of the concrete below. It worked, as I scrapped the concrete with my arm, I rolled my body around the concrete. I rolled till I heard a large bunk-like sound on my head. I then became dizzy and disoriented, yet I could still make out the blue car I hit within the corner of my eye. I simply just wanted my wallet, my precious money that I poured hard work to get. I didn’t mean to hit the blue car, yet my thoughts temporarily stopped when I saw that there was a faded silhouette of a woman within the wreckage. It was clear that the silhouette looked to be motionless, as if it was an object instead of a living thing. Curiosity lingered in my mind whilst looking at that silhouette. Gradually, a question began to linger in my head, what can turn death into fortune? The motionless silhouette of the woman looked like a dead person. Although, I answered my own question in my head with hard work, of course. Without hard work, we all would be dead anyway. Yet, in my attempt to find James and get my hard work back, it appeared that I may have inadvertently taken the life of this woman. A mere casualty in my quest to maintain my precious hard work.

Wait, that person is what now? Oh, no! Why? Why? Why is this happening? I am a good person! I did everything right! Yet, in my attempt to make things right, I made things worse! Did my desire for hard work lead to the possible death of this woman? Maybe if she just looked a little harder, then she may have stopped before

I came through? In shock, I stared at the destroyed blue car. It was a nice car, yet I couldn't stop thinking about the connections between death and hard work while looking at the wreckage. If hard work derives meaning into life, then why is death, the most meaningful thing in existence, so easy to happen!? Wait—, no, no, no! This cannot be? Death is where meaning comes from? So, without death, moments have no weight to them and that includes work itself? Shaking in agony, I couldn't find an answer to this burning question. I just wanted my wallet so badly! Oh, why is this happening to me? I thought in my head, what if I just save that woman? Yet, her motionless demeanor in her silhouette showed me that I couldn't save her now. Feeling a ringing pain on my head, my vision blurred, amerced within the shock of the incident I began to feel a sense of disconnect with the world. My actions felt as if they could not impact the space around me. It is such a surreal feeling to have.

Whilst the feeling lingered on, my head trailed off in thought. Lingered in my head, I thought about my answer to the question of what can turn death into fortune? One can save another to bring fortune from death, right? This woman would have been saved if I had just worked harder to save her! I could of looked around while driving with more intent. Yet, laying on the edge of the cold, uncomfortable sidewalk, a thought bulldozed into my head. If I wasn't so concerned about my compensation for my hard work within my wallet, then I would have had more intent to look around the road while I was driving. So, does that mean that my hard work indirectly led to the death of this woman?

No, impossible! Hard work can only bring good into this broken world. It is hard work, it is fought for with sacrifices beyond the distant rainbow. Bringing food to the table to continue a dignified life, yet again. Yet, I was witnessing a motionless silhouette of a person that became like that because I wanted my wallet. It then came to me, in the cold fading dusk, I realized that my greed, my desires led to this person to become like this. The meaning of hard work is indeed mysterious. Yet, it is bluntly clear to me that hard work is not the inevitable pillar of meaning and understanding in life that I initially thought it was. If that was the case, then this woman would mean nothing to me because she is not working right now. She is motionless right now! Yes! She is lazy right now. Merely sleeping in an inconvenient time and place. I felt a sense of meaning flow through my veins. Yet, I felt meaning in my recklessness, she is impacting me by simply doing nothing.

Not only that, but I feel so impacted by her motionlessness that I cannot focus on anything else. Even if she was sleeping, I was still deriving meaning from her lack of hard work right now. Staring in shock at her motionless silhouette, I suddenly had a confusing thought that hard work may not be all that there is to this world?

Chapter 4

The Realization

I lay there, motionless, yet breathing heavily. Looking at the wreckage, I heard a soft, yet sporadic sound of footsteps. I could tell by the sound that it must be James. I remember those footstep sounds back from my Benchmarks Seafood venture. James would always make those sounds with his feet like a machine without its gears on. It was indeed very funny to hear, even within the horrors to which I was witnessing. I heard James talk to me, but my ear was ringing in such a loud tone that I couldn't make out what James said. He then placed down something next to me. I slowly reached my hand towards the sound of the placed object. Once I grabbed it, I knew immediately that it was my wallet! I knew it, James did take my wallet. Although, was all this destruction worth it?

I honestly don't think so. I felt James's hand on my arm, and I began to feel the cold rough sidewalk scrape through my skin. In agonizing pain, I realized that I was being dragged. It felt like as long as corn seeds growing up into a maze, but eventually my vision of the wreckage was blocked by a bland cement building. Exhausted and full of pain, I felt unaware of my surroundings. Yet, I could feel my consciousness regaining its strength. Reality was coming back for me. I wanted to talk to James to understand what on Earth was going on. I am in a dark and damp alleyway. It felt so cold and unprofessional to be here. Yet, James said to me in a concerned voice, "Jay? Jay? Hello, are you ok? What are we going to do now? Hello? Jay?" I tried to respond, but my shock stunned my mouth, which incapacitated my ability to speak. Yet, somehow James looked at me and our eyes locked at each other. A stare commenced that felt longer than it should have been. Yet, I noticed that after the uncomfortable stare, James looked to be more at ease in his body motions and posture.

My arm is so painful, it felt like a piece of wood with nails scraped on my skin and

I had to endure that pain for such a long time. Wait—, James had a pouch? It looked like to be a first aid kit? Why would James have a first aid kit in his pocket? I know that men tend to have large pockets, but James never came across as a prepared person. My vision then cleared up a little from the craziness I witnessed, and I saw that there was a first aid compartment within the walls of this alleyway. I guess James is smarter than I thought. Once James finished BandAiding my wound, I felt my pain begin to wither away like how a 15-dollar flatbread can be gobbled up in a single minute.

James began to look around the alleyway and he pointed at something. I slowly moved my head towards what James was pointing at and it was an entrance to the city sewer system. A circular grey metal disk covered the entrance. James then walked up to the metal disk and tried to lift the metal disk up, but he struggled a lot to lift the thing up. After a few tries, James looked to grow tired in his posture. In the fury of struggle, James eventually lifted the disk halfway till it could be knocked over. James then said to me in a tired and discommoded voice, “Jay, please he—lp me! For the business’s sake!” I didn’t know what James meant by that, but regardless I found the strength to weakly get to the metal disk and lift it up with James’s help. Suddenly a burden of weight as strong as a wave of water consuming a failed surfer left my hands. The metal disk landed on the concrete floor of the alleyway in a loud thunder that shook me to my core. I had made it, no we had made it. Me and James had did it. So, James entered the sewer in a quick concerned manner and once he made it to the sewer I went down into the horribly smelly sewer. James supported me coming down by holding me at my feet and then holding me on my hips. My descent took a while in comparison to James’s descent into the sewer, but I did it.

Once I reached the floor of the smelly sewer, James climbed back up to the entrance to close up the sewer entrance. Once he did that, the little light that shined like a lantern onto the sewer dissipated into darkness. I could not see James or anything for that matter, fear began to consume me like how the smell of hot fresh bread consumes my focus on life. I heard footsteps next to me, I couldn’t figure out what was happening. Luckily, I felt mentally good enough to walk upright now. Although, a sharp pain still persisted within my poor arm. Suddenly, I heard a voice that whispered, “Jay, I am right in front of you, it’s me, James. Don’t worry,

we just need to walk. Away from the entrance to this disgusting sewer.”

It was really creepy to know that James was right in front of me, yet I couldn't see him at all. The sewer was pitch black like as if God spilled black oil paint onto the universe. I just began to walk into the darkness. I had no other choice, I may not trust James, especially since he stole my wallet, but he did help me mostly recover from my injury. So, I should at least trust in him for whatever he has in store for me. Whilst walking in the pitch-black nothingness, I heard a voice say to me in a concerned tone, “Jay, I forgot to say this to you. I brought you into this sewer because I don't want you to go to jail because of something that I did. So, just trust me Jay for at least one more time and maybe us and our business could survive this.” What had happened? During the morning, we were so confident that this business was going to be a success. Now, we were uncertain that we would ever be free ever again. I was too tired to complain to James about my wallet, I wanted James's help anyway. If something is going to happen to me and James is willing enough to try to save me, then I should do what James wants me to do for now. Besides, walking in the horrendously smelly darkness was a comfort, not a debacle. Since smelly nothingness is better than the loss of one's freedom.

Even in my reaffirmed trust in James, I still had a deep longing to know about how the future of the serving of others within the business would pan out. So, I asked James in a confused tone, “How are we ever going to serve others again?” I heard a gargling snuff in the darkness and then a disgruntled voice said to me, “Service? Jay what is service to you? Is it like saving a dog drowning in the icy cold water or is it to work non-stop till your muscles give way?” What question is that? Service is a duty, it is not something we choose. Hard work might not be everything, but service can save someone from death. I know it can! So, I knew what I had to say to James in the dark horrendously smelly sewer, “James, service is working till your muscles give way because service is something we do, it is hard work that ultimately makes service work. It takes hard work to save a dog drowning in icy water, doesn't it James?”

I couldn't see James' facial expression, so I had no idea what he was thinking. I then heard a voice spark back at me, “Hey Jay, if you think you know so much about service, then answer this question. Would a lesser effort on saving the dog be

less impactful than a greater effort on saving the dog?” After hearing what James had to say, I got tied up in confusion. I didn’t know what to say? Saving the dog is impactful, yet to discern the impact between more or less effort on saving the dog was just too new and complicated for me. Hearing this question in a more peaceful environment has forced me to come to the realization that I don’t know the answer to James’s question. Full of dreadful shock, I didn’t know what to do, so I simply stopped talking to James and I decided to try to ignore James’s question. That question just didn’t sit well with me. I just wanted to think more about service before any further conclusions can be made. Therefore, I moved my attention towards trying to walk onwards into the endless smelly darkness.

Yet, my mind wanted to wonder and wonder it did. Service is supposed to be a duty that workers do to satisfy those that pay for their service. Yet, something did feel off about this mindset that I had not realized before. Yet, I couldn’t figure out what felt off about viewing service as a duty to customers. The answer seemed like it was very far away from me, as if it was another galaxy away from me. It didn’t feel real, the criticism of such a fundamental fact of human life in my head that was forming felt wrong on a fundamental level. Yet, my mind wanted to wander towards the direction of exploration and that meant that my mind dove deeper into the question of is service supposed to be a duty? Suddenly, whilst I was thinking about James’ question, I stepped on something sticky within this smelly sewer. It felt chunky and gooey at the same time. I think I may know what it is, but I refuse to believe it. Suddenly, James gave out a loud, “Augggghhhh! This is gross! What is this?!” I decided to not answer that question in fear that conversations would arise that would scare me to my core.

We walked through this gooey chunky mess for a long time. It felt that an eternity had passed, and we were still in this pitch black sewer. In what felt like watching a drop of water move from one side of a lake to another, the chunky gooey feeling on my feet finally ended. Yet, I couldn’t see anything at all. With the gross goo gone from my senses, I refocused on the question James asked me about service. I thought that if service is a duty, then was it my duty to crash my car into that woman’s car? Was that even service? If it was, then why is the woman not thanking me? Did I do something wrong? Wait, I likely did since that woman never even moved when I saw her silhouette. As if something really bad had happened to her. I

think she might be dead, but I don't know for sure? Maybe I didn't even do the car crash, maybe it was all her fault. Although, either way that happened it doesn't change that if service is a duty, then I failed at serving her. What about my time as the CEO of Benchmarks Seafood? Was that service done with duty in mind? If it was, then I have failed at serving my employees and my customers by going out of business. However, Partaceyist Fishes is trying to regain that service to the people. I just don't know if that service I am looking for is the service that the people desire? I felt dizzy in the awe that I may be wrong about my view on life. I felt an uncomfortable sense of uncertainty within me. It is something that I must resolve, yet I have no idea how to resolve it. I thought about this whilst walking in the darkness. That was until I suddenly heard steps on something other than the sewer floor. I felt confused since it had been a while since I heard something else than steps on the sewer floor. Suddenly, a dim moon light speeded throughout the sewer. I could see my hands! I could see James! He was walking on the ladder heading out of the sewer.

James then grabbed me in my good arm, and I climbed up the ladder to freedom at last. Once I could poke my head out of the sewer, James grabbed my hips and pulled me out of the sewer. To my amazement, I saw the environment of suburbia within the moonlight. Strikingly, this suburbia looked familiar to me as if it felt close to home. Home!? Ah yes, I just want to go home and see my dear wife. My beautiful wife, no, not my beautiful wife, but my beautiful dear Siyanda. Yet, in my eyesight, I could still see James. Now that I knew I was safe for the time being, I could ask James why that good for nothing idiot took my wallet.

Therefore, I decided to ask James on the sidewalk of this suburbia with a stubborn blend of an angry tone, "Hey James! Why did you take my wallet? Because of what you did, that woman is likely injured or something! You are such an inconsiderate human being!" James looked at me with a sense of puny concern in his eyes. We locked eyes at each other for what felt like forever. Endless dread filled me, yet I waited to see what this excuse for a human would do to save himself. Suddenly, James splattered out, "Jay, I wanted to teach you a lesson. Although, it seemed that my lesson went too far. I am sorry for what I did to you. Can we move on from this? You have your wallet now and there is nothing you can do to help that woman now. Please, for our business's sake, let's find a safe place to

rest. Would you forgive me?”

I wanted to strike James with force, I wanted to show James the harm he had caused onto me. He had tried to take my hard earned work! Yet, he was right. I needed a safe place to rest for now and I already had my wallet. So, really what is there left to be angry at? I dislike James’s strategy to help me, but I liked that James was helping me at all. So, I responded back at James in a stubbornly understanding tone, “I see, I don’t like what you did, but you are helping me. So, I will forgive you for stealing my wallet. Although, please never steal from me again.” James looked at me with a growing gleaming sense of hope in his eyes. He then said back to me, “Thank you Jay, we both really needed that. Now, where are you planning on going towards?” Wait, James didn’t know where he was going! What a little nerd! He is blindly helping me without any regard for his life at all. James is crazy! Luckily for James, I already knew my answer. So, I said back to James in a remembrance-like tone, “Home, and I think I know where to find my home.”

I pointed westward for James to see where I thought my house was located given the familiar looking neighborhood. James shook his head in acceptance, and we began to walk towards my house. The tension I had with James felt more distant as my mind began to wonder. Whilst I was walking, my mind wondered about my wife, my dear Siyanda. Will my dear Siyanda be willing to accept me for coming home so late? I didn’t know the answer to that. Although, that is the risk one must take to do hard work. Hard work, I thought about that really deeply while I walked with James to my house. While walking, the dim moon light gave me a faint gloomy vibe. It didn’t ruin my spirits or anything, but it did felt like a burden of some kind. While this was happening, I thought about my dear Siyanda. I loved my dear Siyanda, and I didn’t want my dear Siyanda to dislike me in any way whatsoever. She is such a beauty, I just want her comfort after a hard day. Yet, something came up in my mind about my dear Siyanda. If hard work is not everything there is to life, then is it possible that my hard work loving my dear Siyanda is for not? Is there something that I am missing in my relationship with my dear Siyanda that is detrimental to her? Aughhhh! I don’t know, I just don’t want my dear Siyanda to be burdened by me if I become a burden to her.

I love her so much! I can't allow myself to see her beauty fade into despair. I can't allow that! An overly loud stomp from James's feet got my mind off of my dear Siyanda. I noticed that walking with James, who was looking around half hazardingly, felt so unreal. The lazy boy is leading the team? What is happening? Didn't I, who did the hard work, deserve the privilege to lead the team? Yet, I couldn't do such a thing. I felt unable to lead the way, I felt weak. I felt so lost in my mind, thinking about hard work was such a burden. Hard work is not everything? What did that even mean? I simply had no clue, so I began to think that my initial thoughts while looking at the motionless silhouette must have been wrong. I began to doubt that hard work could really be not everything in this world. I mean, what can be done without hard work? I can't name a single thing which you can do without work. Yet, my extraordinary experience at that wreckage burdened me to stay just in doubt about hard work. I couldn't go back to what I was before. As much as I wanted to believe in the universality of hard work again, I simply couldn't since I felt something when nothing happened.

Walking for what seemed like an hour, the landscape became more familiar as I went along. Then, at last! I could finally see the delicate outline of my house. We had somehow made it without being detected by the police. What a miracle! I felt relief like how a girl would feel relief to relax within the sandy beaches of the Bahamas. While walking towards my house, I decided to look at James because I still felt a sense of distrust towards James. I would not want James to bud in on my family life after what he did to me. Yes, I forgave James of what he did to me, but forgiveness doesn't slay the distrust he had poured into me from stealing from me. A man that will use force to try to get their way is a man that cannot be trusted. If that man is willing to use force to teach others a lesson, then what can stop him from using force to make things right in the view of himself?

I just couldn't fully trust James right now. So, I said to James in a cautious voice, "James, I think you should stay here, behind the trees around my house. I will check and see if my wife is still awake. If my wife is not awake, then you can sleep on the couch. I just want to communicate personally with my wife to calm her if she is feeling unwell because of me in any way." James looked at me with a look of mild understanding. He then said back to me, "I agree, Jay. I will just stay in the tree line. Although, please signal to me when I can come it." I said back to James,

“Yes, I will. You will have nothing to worry about.” Looking at my house, I decided to walk to my house in a confident stride. I hope that my dear Siyanda would be asleep, so that I can just sleep with her and end this dreadful day. Yet, while I was walking to the front porch of my house, I noticed that the door opened, showing my beautiful dear Siyanda, and then she closed the door with a loud thud.

(Siyanda’s viewpoint) I am standing next to my handsome husband, Jay! I have always felt inside of me that he was always there for me throughout the days. Yet today, my dear Jay didn’t notify me that he was leaving. My dear Jay would always at least tell me that he was leaving for work. Yet, today he didn’t. To my surprise, my dear Jay had a perplexed facial expression when looking at me. My dear Jay then said to me nervously, “Oh!? Honey, I’m home!” Yeah, something was up with my dear Jay’s voice. I could tell that something suspicious was up. Thus, I said back at my lovely dear Jay with a concerned voice baked with care, “Jay, why are you home so late?” Jay looked at me with deep compassion and an innumerable glance and said to me in a sorrowful voice, “I am sorry honey, there was a traffic accident and I got stuck in traffic. Would you forgive me, sweetie?”

Looking at my dear Jay, I knew I wanted to scream at him. My dear Jay is never home, I simply want my dear Jay to tell me that he is leaving every day. If he is truly a hard worker, then a little reassurance from my dear Jay would barely be an issue for my beloved dear Jay. Yet, today it is clear to me that my dear Jay saw this business venture as more important than me. Yet, I still care and trust in my dear Jay. I see a hardworking man in my dear Jay that can save my family from the dangers of this world. I needed my dear Jay and I presume that my kids needed my dear Jay too. Although, I cannot forgive my dear Jay for what he did to me today! He didn’t tell me he was leaving for work today!? So, I said to my dear Jay in a demanding voice, “Jay, I cannot forgive you. You didn’t tell me that you were leaving today! How could you?!” My dear Jay looked at me with a confusing facial expression, showing me his typical charming ignorance. My dear Jay then said back at me in a harsh demanding tone, “Honey, this is what this is about? This is why you are still awake at this hour? I didn’t tell you that I was leaving? I leave every day honey! That’s normal!”

Normal?! There is nothing normal about a relationship that has the man leave for

the vast majority of the day and the women stays idly by as the man does the so-called work. Work is supposed to help my family, yet my dear Jay is never here as a father because of his work. I have had enough of this work; I just want my dear Jay to be good to his children and good to me. That's all I want, and I never get it. So, I said back to my dear Jay in a concerned voice, "Jay, I just feel that we need more social time together, for our kids' sake." My dear Jay gave a reassuring nod of approval and said to me in a reassuring voice, "Yes, I do want to spend more time with you, Siyanda. Yet, I can't. I need to work for our survival as a family. Bills need to be paid; you know." I understood that bills needed to be paid, yet what I didn't get was that bill paying needed to take the whole day away from me? No, I refuse to allow bill payments to get in the way of our relationship! Work needs to take a sidestep! I needed my dear Jay! Thus, I said to my dear Jay in a sassy voice, "Then, I should step in and help you pay your bills. What do you think of that, Jay?"

Jay looked at me with a brief sense of curiosity in his eyes. I could see a future with me and my dear Jay helping with his business venture. Our kids can have a babysitter, everything will be fine! My dear Jay then said to me in a tough voice, "No honey, I don't think the kids will handle that very well. Who will be there for the kids?" Wait—, since when did my dear Jay ever care for the kids, that's when I knew that something was off with my dear Jay. He would never say such a thing. I think my dear Jay is trying to get me to stop thinking about helping him, but why? Why would my Jay want more time with me, yet not allow me to participate in his hard work? This can't last! So, I said to my dear Jay in a reassuring voice, "Jay, our kids will be fine, we can hire a babysitter for them." My dear Jay quickly responded back, saying in a strictly demanding voice, "Honey! Our kids need your presence, they rely on you! You are supposed to be always there for them!" I quickly instinctively responded back, saying, "But what if I want you instead?" Jay looked at me with a glowing stare that reminded me of a light flickering on and off. Wait—, is he getting angry at me? I quickly developed a sense of fear in thinking that my dear Jay may be getting angry at me. I don't want my dear Jay to dislike me in any way.

I felt isolated and scared, I just wanted my dear Jay! Why is this happening to me? I began to squirm around, moving my arms and legs in a pacing motion. Jay looked

to noticed my pacing posture and he said to me in a comforting voice, “Honey, are you ok? Let’s just go inside. It’s been a long day.” I wanted to say nothing, but I lashed out at my dear Jay and said to him, “Jay? Do you like me, or do you like your work more?” I stared at my Jay with an intent that rivaled that of a fly trying to steal my food on a hot summer afternoon. My dear Jay took some time to respond, once I noticed that my dear Jay was not quickly responding to my question. I began to say something and as my dear Jay began to speak, “I—.” I shouted with a crying tone within my voice, “Jay!? Why do you come to me if you like your work more than me?! I know you love me, so just love me!”

My dear Jay gave me a glance of concern, yet I saw a drop of rage in his eyes. My dear Jay then looked to develop a sense of sadness within his eyes. My dear Jay said back to me in a crying tone, “Fine, if you don’t trust me, then what can be left of our relationship?” My beloved dear Jay then began to walk away from our front porch. I had really messed up. When my dear Jay stopped arguing with me, I began to feel an abnormal wave of tiredness and sadness overcoming me. So, I couldn’t forge the energy to say anything back to my dear Jay to get him back. I just wanted to get out of this nightmare. So, unable to cheer up my dear Jay, I walked with a defeated stride back to our house, crying as crazily as a hyena on stilts. I slowly opened our door, and I closed our door with a slam of regret and sadness to hope that my dear Jay would hear my cry.

(Jay’s viewpoint) Did I mess up? Did I hear something? Aughhhh! I don’t know. I just want to sleep with my dear Siyanda and forget about this nightmarish day. Yet, I could feel a sense of shocking distrust for my dear Siyanda within me. A force so lingeringly present that it was like reckless flies on a hot humid summer in a damp swamp. I couldn’t get this force of distrust out of my head. I need this out of my head! This shouldn’t be happening to me!? I am a father and a hard worker! I should be a role model to my dear Siyanda! Yet, in that fateful moment, I couldn’t think straight at all. Why? I love my dear Siyanda so much. My answer should have been instant! Yet, my dear Siyanda assumed that I truly loved hard work more than her. Why? Why is my dear Siyanda being so rude to me? I worked so hard for Siyanda, yet I had failed her. Failed? It takes little work to fail, yet a lot of work to succeed. Why? Why is failure the thing that is easy? Why is the world allowing this to happen? The worst thing is the easiest thing to happen!? What a disaster!

What is even the point of work if work can just be annihilated into failure? Wait—, what now? A wave of starkly confusing thoughts came into my head. The king of these thoughts was, is hard work failure or success? Suddenly, I realized that I didn't know the answer as if my mind was dead. Dead? My mind then lingered back into my harsh question, can one turn death into fortune? I didn't know the answer to that either, I just wanted to ignore that lingering question that always came back like a hungry cat that I wished was full. All I could do was to walk back to James, at least James would stay with me unlike my dear Siyanda when things get confusing.

I dizzily walked with a stride that emulated confusion. I eventually reached James, hiding in my property's tree line like what I told him to do. James was standing next to a tree; he was a dim figure only visible within the moonlight. James looked at me with a confused and concerned glance that emulated the illusion of trust within him. I knew I truly cannot trust James completely, but right now I just needed a place to rest to allow the chaos of my wreckage to calm down. I wanted to talk to James, yet before I could say anything, he spoke to me with a concerned voice, "Hey Jay, what happened there?" I didn't know what to say to James, so I simply said back to James in a dreadful tone, "My house is inaccessible, we are doomed." James looked at me with concern dwelling within his eyes. James began to be more discombobulated, and he spun his head back and forward. I felt defeated. I wanted to just sleep on the dirt where I belong. James began to walk sporadically, and I was initially afraid that my dear Siyanda may spot him in our yard. Yet, to my utter surprise, like how a cow can be surprised in a thunderstorm, I was surprised that my house lights suddenly turned off all at once.

Darkness grew throughout my own yard. It was sudden, as if darkness had decisively slain the lights of my house. I could still see James, but being dizzy and full of dreadful sadness, I was unable to properly communicate with James. Yet, in the dim moon light, I barely saw James's hand directed at something. I didn't know what James was doing, but at this point I didn't care. What if the police find me and arrest me for crashing my car? Our business would be doomed! Our business? Why did I think that? Staring at the dim moonlight that showed me James, I saw a person that was on my team. A team that I created, yet now I had no choice. I must accept James's help for the sake of Partaceyist Fishes to have a future. So, I

followed where I saw James pointing at. James walked nearby me. Dizzily walking in the night, it was as if I was in a dream, and I was about to wake up. Yet, here I am now, walking and trusting in a man that I didn't fully trusted. I am really a failure. Yet, I did work hard to become this failure I am right now. That thought at least gave me the slimmest ounce of hope whilst I walked with James. Finally, we made it to where James pointed at. It was a trash can. What on Earth was James thinking? James looked at me with a sense of nostalgia in his eyes? What? I stared at James, perplexed at him and his fixation on his trash can. Then, out of a sudden, James said to me in a confident voice, "Jay, if we sleep in this trash can, then we can never be detected. No one thinks about the trash can!" I nodded in agreement with James, not because I agreed with him, but because I simply was too tired and sad to resist James's idea.

Therefore, James opened up the trash can lid and elegantly got into the trash can. When James was in the trash can, he grabbed me by my waist. I noticed that my arm felt much better, I believe that it was just bruised from scrapping the concrete. Yet, James still took the care and time to grab me by my waist and slowly pull me up into the trash can. I had to place my feet onto the top of the trash can to generate enough lift to get up into that trash can. After struggling to get into the trash can, I fell into a pile of extraordinarily smelly rotting food on my good arm. Hot dogs, chips, beef, eggs, tomatoes, carrots, and even apple sauce were all around me. My good arm felt fine, but what didn't feel fine with me was the look on James's face. James looked to be comfortable in this utterly disgusting place. What on Earth is my life?! James then said to me in a lighthearted tone, "It may be smelly, but that's why no one comes here." James then began to search for something. James injected his hands into the filth with a shockingly confident stare into the filth. James searched and searched and eventually he found something. An overused, dirty, and holey pillow. James then gave this sad excuse for a pillow to me, and I had to accept his offer. I just wanted to sleep this nightmare away. James then found another even more torn up pillow and things looked like they were coming together in a weird way. James then grabbed the trash can lid and he closed it shut, condemning this place into darkness.

(James's viewpoint) The trash can became dark, pitch black dark. I am used to the terribly smelly, dark, and sticky atmosphere of a trash can that I just felt like I was

at home. Before I closed the trash can lid, my boss looked to not have the same opinion as me. Yet, after five minutes of silence, I heard a loud snore. It sounded like my boss was doing just fine. I knew that I needed my boss because I have nothing without Partaceyist Fishes. My boss may have a wife and a family to go to, but if Partaceyist Fishes fails, then I will live in a trash can once again, struggling to make ends meet. I had to save my boss, so that I can save Partaceyist Fishes from any reputation damage from my mistake. I am the one that stole my boss's wallet. So, I should be held responsible for the wreckage, right? If I do that, then will Partaceyist Fishes fall with me? I don't think my boss is able to run a Partaceyist business on his own?

Yet, whilst I was thinking about my boss not being fit for running a Partaceyist business. I noticed that my snoring boss is in a scenario like mine back at Benchmarks Seafood. My boss looked to be lost, I was lost too. Lost in the burden of work. I was sleeping in a trash can back at Benchmarks Seafood, my boss is sleeping in a trash can, right now. I had no one to help me while at Benchmarks Seafood, but my boss has me, right now. A hopeful feeling overcame me. I felt like me and my boss weren't so different after all. We are both humans trying to live in a broken world. I realized that my boss was more like me than I had ever realized. I have been seeing him as my boss for all of this time. Yet, his name is Jay Tabor, not my boss. Looking into the darkness at that silly snoring Jay, I decided to fall asleep with Jay within this disgustingly smelly cramped trash can.

I ran—, I ran so fast that my arms were more like inflatables than fleshy meat things. I ran like the loser I was. Wait, I am a loser? No, you cholesterol infested gummy bears! I will not bow down before you! I am a winner!!!! As I ran back at those cholesterol infested gummy bears, holding the sword of wonders, I felt the whole world shake at my presence. Suddenly, I saw a dim light, and the world faded away like a piece of paper burning on a fireplace, then I heard, "James! Wake up!" I felt my arms in a posture that was initially unfamiliar to me. Opening up my eyes, I saw what had happened. The trash can had been flipped over onto its side. Trash was on the ground, liquid-like chunky gross trash, so gross that I wanted to look away from it. I saw Jay, with a disgusted expression on his face, standing next to me with his good arm on my shoulder. I then looked down onto his feet and saw what that gross trash was. It was the goo that we stepped into while we were at the

sewer. It looked like we both got that stuff on our shoes. I wondered if that's why Jay had been unable to allow us into his home? I asked Jay with a slightly hopeful, yet mostly concerned voice, "Good morning, Jay, do you think we can come into your house now?" Jay looked at me and shook his head with a resounding look of sorrow in his eyes. Jay then said to me with a sorrowful tone, "I don't know if my wife trusts me, and I was lucky that the darkness last night blocked her view of all this filth on me. If I went back to my porch right now, then my wife would get confused or even angry. I can't have that, so I am staying here for now."

I looked at Jay with a sense of understanding, yet it was a fake expression of understanding. I knew nothing of why Jay and his wife were not getting along. It is not my business to deal with. Although, I knew that what was my business to deal with was Partaceyist Fishes. So, I asked Jay in a confused tone, "If you're staying here, then what about Partaceyist Fishes? We lost our car and all our Walleye. Without you, Jay, Partaceyist Fishes will fall." Jay looked at me with conviction in his eyes. I could tell he was going to say something important. So, I prepared to listen to what Jay had to say. Jay then said back to me in a defeated tone, "James, I need to stay here. My wife needs me, and I need her. If I go with you, what would we do? We have nothing left of Partaceyist Fishes. The business is gone. Also, I am technically a fugitive, right now. If I stay here, I am a husband and if I go out there, I will be a fugitive. I want to be a husband to the woman I love. I want to work hard to love her even more than I do now! James, I can't participate in Partaceyist Fishes any longer. For my own sake, I must quit being a co-owner with you." I stood there in awe. I couldn't believe it! Jay was quitting, the hard worker is quitting? Something must be wrong with Jay! Also, what about me? I need the business to survive!

So, I said back to Jay with a concerned voice, "Wait, what about me? I can't run a business on my own. I have no credentials! Your quitting will doom me! Please reconsider staying with Partaceyist Fishes." Jay looked at me with eyes of determination, he then said to me in a determined tone, "James, remember that landlord?" I shook my head like a lost puppy at Jay. Jay then said to me, "Well then, you should do your magic or whatever you did to Jared and save the business." I looked at Jay with a stunning sense of amusement. It was that simple? It sounded wrong like a male anglerfish. Those things live such sad lives. Anyway,

seriously, is it that simple to save this business? In shock, I stared at Jay. I think his plan might work without him. Jared wanted to help out with our business. I convinced him myself. I knew that Jay secretly placing his copy of *The Partaceyist Manifesto* in the back seat of the car under a raincoat was a great move. I took it while he was waiting for Jared. Oh, in hindsight, I think that was the best decision I had ever made. I read *The Partaceyist Manifesto* fully with Jared and Jared got hooked on Partaceyism. He loved the conversations we had about the possibilities of Partaceyism. I did make sure that I placed his copy of *The Partaceyist Manifesto* back on the back seat of his car. I did it for Jay and me, not just for me. So, I don't feel bad about it at all. Now, Jay was telling me to go to Jared and have him reconsider helping our business out. I think this plan might just work.

So, I said back at Jay with an amused voice, "Jay, I think you are onto something." Suddenly, my facial expression went from amusement to concern as fast as a cheetah that's late for a meal. I had no car, no means nor knowledge on where Jared was or any way to get to Jared. I am still doomed. Yet, I was curious on why Jay didn't think about my lack of transportation. So, I asked Jay whilst I was beginning to stand up, "Hey Jay, how am I going to find Jared?" Jay initially looked at me with a stare that reminded me of retired people. Although, suddenly, his facial expression glowed up into gleeful excitement.

He then said to me in an excitedly tired tone, "James, I need rest. Yet, I care for this business too. So, I'll do this." Jay then cautiously walked towards his garage, which was nearby the trash can. It was simply across the yard next to the tree line. I watched Jay opened up the garage door and out appeared a shiny red mustang. Full of excitement, I ran towards Jay with happiness that could drown a stuffed turtle. Once I got to Jay, he then grabbed a key hanging from the wall of the garage and gave it to me. Jay then said to me with a little bit of light sarcasm, "I bestow my wife's mustang to you, James. Please eventually bring it back, I will explain everything to my wife, and I hope that love will seal the patches within. Go James, save our Partaceyist business!" I thought Jay was being a little bit crazy, yet I knew his desire for success. So, I accepted Jay's gift to me, and I got into that beautiful red mustang. I turned on that loud crispy engine and I zoomed out of Jay's driveway. I saw Jay wave back at me as I zoomed away into the distance. Although, as he continued to wave back at me, I noticed that Jay began to wave

more inconsistently and oddly. I decided to ignore it, since Jay had given me a purpose to serve.

Whilst I was zooming the red mustang along, I saw the landscape move like a movie. It was amazing! I thought about the parking lot where me and Jay had found Jared. I think Jared may go to the thrift store to get supplies or something. It was a guess, but it is the best clue I have in finding Jared. So, that thrift store parking lot may be a good place to start looking for Jared. So, I zoomed across the road, heading for that bland thrift store that me and Jay were at yesterday.

Although, on my way towards that thrift store, I stopped at a public shower facility. I needed to be cleaned of my filth from sleeping inside of a trash can. So, I took a quick shower, luckily the showers here are free. Although, the quality of the shower was horrendous. It was like taking a shower in a land of spiders and sweat. I even washed my clothes and shoes in the public shower. It was the best I could do, as a broke man, I had no other choice. Although, the hardship of public showers is luckily always short-lived. After waiting for a few long hours to dry my clothes in the sun, I walked back to the red mustang. Once I got into the red mustang, I quickly zoomed away from the public shower facility and went back to traveling towards that thrift store. While I was driving the red mustang, I thought about if I deserve this? I stole Jay's wallet, yes, I did give it back to him. Although, I do admit looking back at it that my method to help Jay was wrong. I was full of anger at Jay while in that old rustic car. I let that anger get into me and now I have to face the possibility that my actions led to that wreckage for the rest of my life.

I don't believe it was Jay's fault, I think it was my fault that the wreckage happened. Yet, I may never get the chance to say that to Jay. For I don't know how long Jay will need to stay at his home. Yeah—, I say all these things about respect from *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, yet I still fail to be respectful to everyone all the time. All I can do now to be respectful is to take the blame for Jay, yet I don't know if he will even accept it. I must be friendly to Jay and honor Jay, for if I don't, then Jay may think that he is alone? Wait, how can I do that? Thinking about my question, I thought about the business me, and Jay built together. If I can honor Jay's wish to save Partaceyist Fishes, then I can give a little bit of hope to Jay. Maybe with that, Jay may not feel alone within this harsh world. Oh man! It must

have been traumatic for Jay to see all of that. I have seen a lot of death during my life, so I could handle it. Although, I don't know if I could say the same for Jay. Feeling a sense of dread, I decided to just continue my mission. Besides, Jay has forgiven me for stealing his wallet. All is fixed now. So, with that out of the way, I refocused on driving towards the thrift store. The drive did take a little bit of time, but I eventually made it to the parking lot of the thrift store.

I parked the red mustang next to the entrance of the thrift store, so that I could spot Jared if I saw him. I waited and waited, a multitude of long hours passed by, and I was still waiting. While waiting, my mind began to wonder about what I said to Jay in the sewer. If someone used a lesser effort to save a drowning dog than someone else, then would the one who used less effort to save the dog be less impactful to that dog? Back at Benchmarks Seafood, I was in service to the customers like a slave with everyone being his master. It was so burdensome and tiring. If service was always burdensome, then why do people always say thank you when you serve them, no matter the effort you put in for them? If service was truly effort-based like what Jay implied, then would customers not thank workers at a certain level of effort towards them. Like, if I just carried out a water to a customer and did nothing else, would I get a thank you? If I do get a thank you, then service is not based on effort, but on something else entirely. To what that is, I have no idea. Thinking about service, I began to look around the parking lot for Jared. The rough texture of the parking lot reminded me of my revelation at this very parking lot. The time that I discovered that the type of respect that Partaceyist Fishes needs is the I help you out type of respect. That type of respect is at its core, service.

Service? Thinking about service, I began to cry whilst looking at the parking lot. All of our adventures, our struggles, and our dreams were forged at this bland parking lot. Our ideas of a life so grandeur was forged in the humblest of places. What a blessing to be a part of something like that. Thinking about my time with Jay Tabor, it was a time of service. We were serving our community by trying out a better way to forge humanity forward. Now, that is what I call purpose. Huh—? Wait just a minute! An idea flowed into my head like a rogue wave. If the type of respect Partaceyist Fishes needs is service, then respect and service must somehow be connected! That's what I need to do! I need to create the conditions within Partaceyist Fishes that allow people to be respectful by allowing the customers to

serve others. Yeah—, I didn't need Jay to figure this out, I figured my own question out myself. I will be the one who impacts the dog by saving that dog from drowning, regardless of the effort I put into the rescue. It's all about the experience of the work, not the ability to do the work. Oh yeah, this work will be something different. I don't know exactly what this type of work may entail, but I am hopeful for it.

Feeling satisfied with myself, I began to relax in the seat of this beautiful red mustang. Although, all of a sudden, I saw out of the corner of my eye a familiar figure. After closer inspection, I noticed that the figure was none other than Jared! Full of enthusiasm, I jumped out of the red mustang. I left the front door of the mustang open, yet I didn't care. I just wanted to save Partaceyist Fishes! So, I ran as fast as a squirrel who was tired but determined to save itself. I ran with such strength in my legs that I felt that I was flying towards Jared at breakneck speeds. Yet, every step felt like a century of progress lagged by. This lagging feeling of my surroundings was fueled by my increasing anticipation for meeting Jared as I got closer to him. After the longest, yet most epic run of my life, I shouted at Jared, "Hello Jared, it's me, James!" Jared looked at me with an initial stare of confusion, yet Jared stopped walking, right next to the entrance into the thrift store. It was simply a miracle that I made it to Jared. Jared, slightly shocked at my presence, said to me, "Oh? Hello James, what brings you here at the thrift store? Are you selling Walleye here again with Jay?" I looked at Jared with hopeful and determined eyes and said back to Jared with a gleeful confident voice, "No, I came to this thrift store for you, Jared. I hope you can reconsider your decision to help out Partaceyist Fishes." Jared gave a glance of intrigue at me. Jared then said to me in a curiously intrigued voice, "James? I loved the idea of Partaceyism a lot. Yet, I can't. From what I saw yesterday, I think that you and Jay are incompatible with each other. I fear that Partaceyist Fishes will become a short-lived experiment that will die like many other small businesses. What makes you think that Partaceyist Fishes has changed now?"

I looked at Jared with a glance of stubborn hope, the type of hope that my parents used to have until the world took them away from me. I then said back at Jared with a slight ounce of enthusiasm, "Jared, I have news for you, Jay has decided to quit Partaceyist Fishes." Jared gasped in an expression of shock and disbelief. Jared

then said to me in a shocked voice, “Jay quit working at Partaceyist Fishes!? The hard worker quitted? I may not know Jay very much, but I at least know that he is one of those hard working type of men. Those people never quit on anything! James, is there something wrong with Jay?” It sounded like Jared was asking if Jay had anything physically wrong with him. So, I quickly shook my head, from side to side, to my knowledge, Jay looked to be troubled, but he is physically fine with only a few scrapes on his arm. Jared then said back to me with a newfound gleeful magic in his eyes, “Well then—, I guess Partaceyist Fishes has changed. I am intrigued in Partaceyism, so James, I will make a deal with you. I am willing to give Partaceyist Fishes an urban cabin that I own. Free of charge, although I expect that due to my respectful action towards Partaceyist Fishes, I should be able to personally get better deals on Walleye than your average noncontributing customer. For you James, simply stay Partaceyist and continue the cheap Walleye for me indefinitely and I will guarantee that Partaceyist Fishes will have a place to stay. So, James, what do you think about this deal?”

Standing in the parking lot of the thrift store, next to the entrance, I felt an overwhelming sense of excitement and joy. I did it. I actually did it! So, I gleefully said back to Jared, “Jared, I accept your deal. Thank you for being such a kind person towards me.” Me and Jared were gleefully smiling, and I was so delighted that I had accomplished my mission for Jay. Although, whilst I was enjoying my accomplishment, I noticed in the corner of my eye a person getting into the red mustang I drove here with. I quickly thought about what I should do. Should I run after that person and risk disrespecting Jared in advertising a business built on respect? I could lose the only opportunity left for the future of Partaceyist Fishes by disrespecting Jared, or should I stay right here where I am and do what Jay told me what I was here to do? I thought really hard about it. After a second, I made my decision and just like that, me and Jared shook hands as tightly as a hook and we began our work together.

One Month Later

It was late into the afternoon. I have been working with my fellow co-owners of Partaceyist Fishes for 7 hours now. I love working at Partaceyist Fishes, we have so

many people coming into our small little restaurant. Jared had been so kind to give me a log cabin in the middle of the parking lot of a mall. Therefore, lots of people who were planning on going shopping in the mall eventually became curious at the new Walleye restaurant in town. Today, we already had about 8,000 visitors come into our restaurant. Not all the visitors that came to Partaceyist Fishes were there to eat. Some wanted to simply donate to our business. Besides, why not? If you donate to the Partaceyist Fishes Company, then your respect for Partaceyist Fishes will actually increase your own personal wealth. This is because at Partaceyist Fishes, we have a policy that the excess wealth you generate by donating towards the Partaceyist Fishes Company will go back towards you. So, many people donate money to us and in return they get respect wealth that they can convert into money. What is so good about this policy is that eventually those that donate a lot will eventually earn enough respect wealth to be able to eat at Partaceyist Fishes.

Yes, me and the workers of Partaceyist Fishes were able to enforce a policy of only using respect wealth within the confines of the log cabin where Partaceyist Fishes is located at. We have cameras at the entrance, kitchen, outside, and our indoor eating areas just to make sure no one is trying to break our company policy or cheat our system. Working on converting the worker-customers' respect wealth into money, which all the workers here had decided in an election to officially call visitors, I couldn't be happier with myself. I was not the boss of the restaurant because no one was. It was relaxing to experience work as a true member of a collective team. I never really felt like an equal before Jay while working with him. Yet, I related a lot with Jay, he had his own struggles with life, and I have had my own struggles with life too.

Looking out at the eating area of the log cabin, it was a humble sight to behold. Partaceyist Fishes had only 30 tables inside of the log cabin and about 50 outdoor tables around the parking lot. We made sure that we talked with the people of the mall that we can turn their parking lots into places with tables and outdoor eating spaces. Full of umbrellas, comfy seating, and games for the kids to enjoy. Oh yes, my favorite game out there is bean bag toss. It is such an addictive game to play with friends. Refocusing myself to my lovely job, I looked at the inside of our humble log cabin. The log cabin had a wooden exterior that glowed like a magical wilderness. On the walls of the log cabin hung fishing rods of various types.

Also, at the front desk of the kitchen, where people can see the chefs make our lovely Walleye. Above the opened window of the kitchen, where people can see chefs cook Walleye, hoisted a large detailed stuffed Walleye. There was a window that could open or close near the front desk of the kitchen because some people don't like the smell of Walleye all the time, so we have the option, if workers or customers want it, to limit the strong smell of Walleye at Partaceyist Fishes.

The people inside of the log cabin were all happy and full of glee. Some visitors were working with us, and some were sitting down to eat. While looking at the people enjoying themselves at Partaceyist Fishes, I thought about the company policy that I helped developed. It is a policy that gives visitors two choices, they can be worker-customers, or they can be regular customers at Partaceyist Fishes. I thought about the concept of worker-customers. I found out about it while talking to that one customer who asked me and Jay about what type of respect do I need to use to get a fish. The answer is the worker-customer. Yet, at Partaceyist Fishes, for those that just want to simply eat and go, there is an option to use your respect wealth to just pay for the experience of the joy of a Partaceyist restaurant. Yet, the first comers have to experience the joy of being respectful and loving towards our visitors to be able to gain respect wealth for themselves or they can convert some of their money into respect wealth at my station. I am at the only so-called converter station in the log cabin at Partaceyist Fishes. This is a small business after all.

At first, a lot of the workers around here that I recruited thought that this was unfair towards customers. Everyone thought that no one would want to go to a restaurant to work and then feast. Yet—, oh! Another worker-customer is ready to deposit their earnings! A woman came up to me and said to me in a gleeful voice, “Hi James! It was such a blast cheering people up for Partaceyist Fishes. I got to see so many kids and adults laugh and have fun. Hey James, don't you think I can have a beer as an additional reward for my actions?” I enjoy it that people know my name, we do have banners of all our full-time workers hung up at the inside eating area. Although, I do admit that mine cringes me a little bit. Looking at the woman, I said to her what I always say to those that want beer here, “Sorry miss, beer is disrespectful for your health. We would be running at a loss if we sold beer here.” The woman looked at me with a sarcastic look of dread in her eyes. Luckily for my

work, sarcasm is not counted as respectful or disrespectful. Sarcasm is simply neutral or of no value as we call it at Partaceyist Fishes. The woman then gave me her list of actions that she did and went to sit down in the seats alongside my line and another worker-customer next to me checked the camera footage.

During the four minutes it took for the worker-customer to double check the woman's list. A quick, yet stunning moment of tension crept up upon me as I waited for the worker-customer to approve or disapprove that the list matched the actions done on camera. Luckily, the camera showed us that she didn't lie about any of her actions that she listed doing. Once I heard that, I calmed myself down. Sometimes people would lie about what they did, so we have cameras to just double check to ensure that fairness is secured at Partaceyist Fishes. I just get emotional for those who have to wait to find out how much they will get, since it changes every time they work at Partaceyist Fishes. So, I began to look at the woman's list and there were 10 actions listed. She valued the 10 actions with our standard fixed valuation at Partaceyist Fishes, a 100. Suddenly, my converting of her actions into respect wealth triggered a memory to pop up in my head. It was that woman that I saw while I was at the carnival, the one who I tried to calculate her love and respect! She was right here! In front of me! Holy cow! This is a small world! I then remembered that I wanted to honor her legacy by having Partaceyist Fishes use the love valuation method that I used on her, our first customer.

Yet, I didn't keep that honor, I threw it away, thinking that the old method was inappropriate for a growing Partaceyist business. Yeah, in the past, Partaceyist Fishes had a method of calculating love and respect with a standard of 10, but that standard was too low to justify for both the workers and customers for Walleye. Oh, I felt that my initial method for the calculation of love and respect was so rushed. If her legacy and fairness was important, then I must make a new system that can more effectively honor her commitment towards our business at such an early stage of development. So, a few weeks ago, I lobbied for the team at Partaceyist Fishes to develop a new method for calculating love and respect. I convinced the team about my new method to calculate love and respect and now Partaceyist Fishes is more prepared for more complicated scenarios, if they ever happen. Anyway, zapping out of my thoughts, I decided to refocused on my job, and I looked at her love valuations, which were: 30-100, 70-100, 60-100, 80-100,

90-100, 60-100, 40-100, 50-100, 90-100, and 20-100. These numbers were relatively good values, so I was a little suspicious. Yet, on the worker-customer side they can make their love valuations however they feel like it because it is their opinion of the respect within their own action done.

I then grabbed my pen, and I wrote down next to her love valuations my own love valuations about her actions. The worker-customer quickly showed the camera footage of the woman's 10 actions that he organized for me while he was double checking that woman's actions. I wrote down; 50-100, 60-100, 10-100, 70-100, 90-100, 80-100, 30-100, 50-100, 60-100, and 70-100. Once I was done writing down my love valuations, which were my opinions on her respect shown within the camera footage. I then called the woman up. She ran up to me like an owl trying to catch a mouse! I then said to the woman with a smile on my face, "Miss, you affirm that you have done 10 actions?" She looked to instinctively shake her head, and she did it instantly, showing me that she was honest. I need to make sure she did 10 actions because the range or fixed valuation increases based on the number of actions done. This is because our new method at Partaceyist Fishes is a system that uses the respect generated from each action individually and divides those individually generated respect ratios by the 100 standard range we have at Partaceyist Fishes. Then, we subtract this ratio by one to get the ratio of disrespect within the actions we value at Partaceyist Fishes that are generated from each action individually. This gives out a number that is the ratio between the respect and disrespect within each action done.

I thought about an example of this, a love valuation of 40-100 would have a disrespect value of 60% and a respect value of 40% of the whole action. I shook my head in acceptance of my brilliant math. I always have to re-comprehend this system in my head, yet I personally believe that this method is much fairer than our previous method of calculating love and respect at Partaceyist Fishes. Now, after we find the ratio of the respect to disrespect of the actions, we then use the fixed valuation times by the actions done for both sides of the trade interaction. This is done to get the total dollar amount for each person. Thinking about this method, I could only see this method of calculating love and respect as a great system! Thinking about the new method of love calculation at Partaceyist Fishes, I temporarily forgot that I was talking to this lady. So, I continued in a sales pitch

tone, “Then, given my calculations, your ten actions have love valuations of: 0.7, 0.3, 0.4, 0.2, 0.1, 0.4, 0.6, 0.5, 0.4, and 0.3 respectfully. For your personal knowledge, my love valuations for your actions are: 0.5, 0.4, 0.9, 0.3, 0.1, 0.2, 0.7, 0.5, 0.4, and 0.3 respectfully. Hence, when added together, you have reached only 7.70 disrespect! That’s pretty good! So, your total pay is $30 + 70 + 60 + 80 + 90 + 60 + 40 + 50 + 90 + 20 + 50 + 60 + 10 + 70 + 90 + 80 + 30 + 50 + 60$ ”.

Whooo...wee... Drowned in the tiredness of my tongue, I mustered my final breath and said, “and 70, which equals 1,160 subtracted by 7.70 = 1,152.30 and divide that by the 2 people here, me and you, and you get 576.15 respect wealth, or given the minimum wage of Michigan being \$12.48 cents, we do 576.15 times by 12.48 to equal (\$7,190.35 divided by $(7.70 \times 12.48) = \$96.10$) = \$74.82, just for you, for your contribution towards the Partaceyist Fishes’ collective rise, my dear!” The woman looked at me with excitement. I could tell that she had forgotten about our encounter, yet looking at her glowing eyes of glee, I knew she would be happy that I changed our calculating love and respect system to honor her commitment to us. I know that *The Partaceyist Manifesto* states that the minimum wage should be times by the total respect and price of the transaction. Yet, here at Partaceyist Fishes, we are a small restaurant that cannot afford such large amounts of money transfers. So, we have a temporary policy of dividing the total USD converted respect and the total USD converted price, which is times by the minimum wage. We at Partaceyist Fishes are planning on doing this until we are more able to do those large money transfers, since Partaceyist Fishes is the only Partaceyist business currently on Earth. Anyway, I was surprised, it took her about 5 minutes to do 10 definable actions for Partaceyist Fishes, and she will get 74 dollars and 82 cents. That’s just amazing!

Sinking back into my thoughts, I began to think about what I love about Partaceyist Fishes, which is that me and the Partaceyist Fishes team developed an incredible system. The woman can go away from our business with her cash, or she can use that earned money to decrease her cost for buying a Walleye at our restaurant. Walleyes at Partaceyist Fishes are only ten dollars per pound. The abundance of donations allows Partaceyist Fishes to decrease the costs of the average thirty-five dollars per pound for Walleye to ten dollars per pound for Walleye. Plus, the respect the customers give to the business for our cheap prices earns us very

needed revenue. Also, she can't use cash at Partaceyist Fishes, so like I always say to the visitors, it's either cash back or fish. Although she can also stick with her respect wealth, yet at Partaceyist Fishes, we like to keep track of the earned wealth of worker-customers, for their own benefit, so they can use any wealth that they gain here to buy a Walleye. One may think this is impossible for a business to justify, since there will be so many variables to consider. Yet, customers are a very strong, kind, and reliable work force indeed.

Also, as a bonus, this policy gives us more wealth, since we are being respectful towards them. Also, Partaceyist Fishes does have the option to convert money into respect wealth, which a lot of people do to just make it simple for us. So, I said to the woman in a calm sales pitch-like voice, "We have an opportunity for you, cash back or fish!? Do you want to use your respect wealth to purchase a Walleye? With your actions you can get seven Walleye by the Pound orders!" She looked at me with glee in her eyes and accepted my proposal. She then stated in an enthusiastic voice, "I want three Walleye by the Pound orders!" Oh! She is a smart little cracker! Her respect towards Partaceyist Fishes paid off those Walleye by the Pound orders. Of course, since we use respect wealth currency here, the cost is what the equivalent of the respect wealth amount is for that 30 dollars that three Walleye by the Pound orders are priced at.

I personally can't think of the exact amount right now, but we have AI software and dedicated worker-customers to figure that out for me. Anyway, I watched in complete jolly as the woman left my station to find a table to sit at and wait for her Walleye by the Pound orders to come. We have waiters at Partaceyist Fishes that will bring out people's orders. The waiters are almost always worker-customers since our full-time workers tend to be mostly at more highly skilled jobs and our worker-customers tend to mostly be at more repetitive low skill jobs. Although, overlapping of these roles is very common within the Partacey. Transient in a lingering state of thought, my mind redirected itself towards thinking about our menu at Partaceyist Fishes, which is just the Whole Walleye Fish, the Walleye by the Pound, and the Sliced Walleye. The business is just too young to have the finances to go beyond Walleye. Also, I think that our team at Partaceyist Fishes want to remain specialized at making Walleye. So, I don't think Partaceyist Fishes is ever going to diversify beyond Walleye products. That would be a spit in the face

at the history of Partaceyist Fishes.

Looking around at the beautiful wooden fishing log cabin aesthetic at Partaceyist Fishes, I felt like I was home. I felt so happy to be here and I was so happy to see so many happy faces. I just wished that Jay was here to see all of this too.

Suddenly, I felt a knock on my shoulder, so I turned around and I saw one of the full-time workers at Partaceyist Fishes. His name was Teddy Jones, and he came to me a few weeks ago after he fled from Fortengal Seafoods. I heard of many bad things coming from that place. It is such a shame that the building of Fortengal Seafoods was once the home of the place where I once worked at. I never want to go there again, that was simply a horrible experience to endure. I really relate to Teddy, since I fled from Benchmarks Seafood for many of the same reasons as he did. Teddy Jones said to me in a sarcastically relaxed and excited voice, “Hey James, look what I found!” Teddy pointed at a large Walleye, fresh and alive in a tank. Now, Teddy is a funny guy, he is also a co-owner of Partaceyist Fishes, so he likes to show off sometimes. The Walleye’s tank was so big that it could barely exit out of the entrance to the kitchen, which was nearby to where my station was at. Suddenly, I heard the crowd at the eating area shout with a collective, “Oooohhhh—!!!! Wow!” They were all amazed at the spectacle of the fat chunky Walleye at display. Teddy Jones said to me with sheer happiness in his eyes, “James! This is our new mascot, Guthrie the Walleye!” I laughed so hard that I could have blown a whale away! Ahh! Teddy was something else. Teddy then moved Guthrie under the banners of all of us. It was so beautiful! I started to cry in happiness while looking at Guthrie’s majestic swimming in his tank.

I was so happy that I went to Teddy, and I said to him with glee on my face, “Teddy! You should get a raise, my boy! You’re so amazing!” Teddy smiled and said back to me, “James, my boy! What do you mean by a raise? We are in a Partacey! We determine our own raises!” Ouf, I keep on mixing the supply and demand way of business to our Partaceyist way of business. It just happens sometimes, a lot of this is simply overwhelming to me. I knew that Teddy was talking about our Fishages, as we call them. Ah Fishages, I love them. Fishages were something that was not originally described in *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, yet every Partacey is different. So, the team of Partaceyist Fishes voted on implementing a new wage system and we called it a Fishage. Teddy's comment

triggered my memory, which made me remember about my Fishage for today. They are 50-100, 60-100, 80-100, 20-100, and so on. The 100s or 100-100 are set to the equivalent of 10 dollars, so 1-100 is the lowest a full-time worker or worker-customer can have his or her action valued at. That would be equivalent to about \$12.36 per action. Yet, no action in a Fishage cannot make you money and we do a lot of actions every single day. It is a brilliant system.

We, the workers, can decide how we value our own work. After we decide our own love valuations, we then let the committee of Partaceyist Fishes, or a rotating group of dedicated visitors, value our own work in between the rankings of 1 to 100 for each definable and recorded action that each worker does on a workday. We do this at Partaceyist Fishes to just make sure that our compensation is not bias to simply what we believe about our respect and work here, but instead we have a compensation based on what the workers feel and what the visitors feel about Partaceyist Fishes. This makes sure that customers' prices can be maintained to be low, and worker pay can be free to increase based on the respect generated at Partaceyist Fishes for each day. Therefore, the everyday customers and worker-customers can have their respect wealth that they generate at Partaceyist Fishes tied up to themselves. Isn't that amazing! Now, where was I? Oh! After a day's work is done, all our earned respect wealth will be sent to a centralized fund, named the collective rise, where it will be equally split up among ourselves or all full-time workers and worker-customers at Partaceyist Fishes. I personally believe that the collective rise makes the Fishage system a very viable solution to the wage system in supply and demand businesses. Ohhh! I just love Fishages so much! Cheering in joyous glee, I went back to my station and helped out more happy people.

While I was helping out with people's conversions of their work and money into respect wealth, I thought about what first motivated me to build Partaceyist Fishes with Jay. I wanted to survive, and I saw Partaceyism as a way to get rich quickly. Yet, now that I am here, I think that my motivation for Partaceyist Fishes has changed. For I am no longer a broke man, I am now a proud mediocrely wealthy man now! So, I no longer see Partaceyist Fishes as my ticket to survival, but I still want to stay at Partaceyist Fishes. I feel a sense of meaning here that no business had ever given me before. A sense of meaning that means that it is not my service

towards Partaceyist Fishes that counts. Instead, it is the collective service of the people associated with this business towards the idea that this business was built upon that counts to me. We are a true refuge for those who need love and respect in this harsh and broken world. I began to cry in tears of joy. I am a part of this movement of happiness and fulfillment, and I am also one of those who needed to be healed. Partaceyist Fishes delivered its promise to me and that makes me so happy to see Partaceyist Fishes become so successful.

Yet, Partaceyist Fishes is not all sunshine and rainbows. The business needs to have a deal with a bank to always secure a money stockpile to give to customers and workers when they transfer their respect wealth into money. Partaceyist Fishes can also trade our respect wealth into money by giving our respect wealth to the local bank, so that the local bank can transfer those respect wealths into money, to then be compensated for the loans that they give to Partaceyist Fishes. Yet, a money stockpile is still needed to ensure compensation in money for all of those that contribute towards the business at all times, if any worker or worker-customer desires to be paid in money. All of this requires us to be in a special partnership with the local bank around here. We are given loaned money by the local bank within the area in the hopes that Partaceyist Fishes will gain the wealth necessary to pay it off at a later date. We have already paid off this month's loan, since Jared convinced the local bank to give us a loan with less interest than normal.

Jared is in cahoots with the local bank administration around here, so Partaceyist Fishes is able to get a good deal with the local bank, which I am so thankful for. We hope that with the vast amounts of people coming to our restaurant and our use of respect in our economy that Partaceyist Fishes can pay off these loans with ease. Although, as long as money dominates the national economy, Partaceyist Fishes will be stuck with applying for loans to be able to have money stockpiles for those who transfer their respect wealth into money. This month, Partaceyist Fishes as a company had borrowed 30,000 dollars from the local bank around here. That is a lot of money, yet Jared is a relatively rich man, and he told me that to secure his cheap Walleye, he wants to help contribute towards paying off 10% of Partaceyist Fishes' loans for the next year.

Here at Partaceyist Fishes, the Walleye is secured to be very cheap, even with our

indebtedness to the local bank because of the separation of price and payment. This works because the expenditures fund for Partaceyist Fishes is funded by the Walleye prices and donations. Albeit donations are more fluid in their use, donations can be used to support money stockpiles for the payment process or the expenditures fund. Hence, the more people that buy Walleye and the more people that support Partaceyist Fishes, the lower our debt will be towards the bank. Although, to prevent greed, hierarchy, and a connection of high prices to success from forming within our ranks, we have decided as a team within Partaceyist Fishes that our expenditures fund must be separated from our pay. Thus, pay at Partaceyist Fishes is determined not by the prices, but it is instead determined by the amount of respect to others and actions we do at Partaceyist Fishes. This policy is also enforced for those worker-customers too. The Partaceyist Fishes Company also has a financial advisor, his name is Ted Lango. Ted Lango helps make sure that the collective rise does not have any wealth from our expenditures fund. He does this to ensure cheap Walleye prices and high pay for workers are maintained at Partaceyist Fishes. Yeah, Ted Lango also always loves to separate our expenditures fund into a donation section and a prices section to keep track of what can be used as money stockpiles for business expenditures or worker payment.

Personally, I love this system, since it gives us a higher pay and it makes Partaceyist Fishes a very competitive restaurant within the market. This business is so much better than when I began working at Partaceyist Fishes. I remember not having any money to compensate for the respect generated by a lady. So, I looked on the floor of that old rustic car and I found two quarters. I wish that I never have to do that ever again to support Partaceyist Fishes, it felt so wrong. Now, I can be proud that Partaceyist Fishes is a proper Partacey. Wait just a minute, since we only took out a loan of 30,000 dollars for this month and every Walleye by the Pound is 10 dollars. Does that mean that we only needed to sell 3,000 Walleye by the Pound orders this month to pay that debt off? We had 8,000 visitors come here, just today! Oh! Partaceyist Fishes is probably in a way better financial position than I initially thought. I think we easily paid off our loan from the revenue we gained today alone. Huh—? I curiously thought to myself, I guess I can be so forgetful sometimes. Thinking about my forgetful nature, I accidentally zapped out of my train of thought. When I realized that I was still working, I decided to put more effort into looking around my station whilst I was working. I first noticed that my

line was long, but not as long as the line to the entrance of Partaceyist Fishes. Oh yes, we were having such a great day today at Partaceyist Fishes! In a gleeful state of happiness, I barely noticed a familiar looking figure opening the entrance door and then calmly closing that door shut.

(Jay's viewpoint) Oh wow! I saw such a wonderful sight. My dream had come into realization. Yet, not in the way I imagined it, but nonetheless my dream is here. I stood in line to get a list to decide what duties I want to do for Partaceyist Fishes. The other line for the regular customers was a little longer than this one, but not by much. Being in this line felt like being one of those people with the Universal Express Pass on a roller coaster at Universal Studios. It felt rewarding to be in the shorter line, yet I knew that this line was shorter because this is the line for the worker-customers at Partaceyist Fishes. I guess consumers do want to work to receive a feast. Anyway, me being in this line is the best I can do for Partaceyist Fishes, since if I become a full-time worker, then people may search for me and find out about my connection to that wreckage. Luckily, the police search warrant ended a few days ago. I found out about the police warrant ending when I read in the daily newspaper that the warrant for the mysterious culprit for the wreckage had ended. What was also in that newspaper was that Partaceyist Fishes was breaking record sales, due to increased money stocks at Partaceyist Fishes. Today is the day for me to finally see Partaceyist Fishes for myself.

As I was in line, I noticed that the line was moving away from the doorway towards the listing station at Partaceyist Fishes, which reminded me of my last experience with James, seeing him drive away from me. Suddenly, the mere memory of James forged a hard and striking blast of sorrowfulness and anger onto me. James!? Oh man! I should never have given James my wife's red mustang! I was blinded by the possibility that Partaceyist Fishes might still have a chance at success. On that fateful day, I realized that Jared would be the key to success for Partaceyist Fishes. Yet, I need to leave the business in order for our conflict to end within Partaceyist Fishes. The last time I saw Jared gave me the impression that he wants stability and I felt that he saw me as instable. So, seeing my life fall apart on that fateful day, I decided to quit Partaceyist Fishes, for the sake of the business's own survival.

It worked, yet it came at a huge cost for me. I needed James to have a ride to meet Jared and I was just too blind to see anything else! Oh! My poor dear Siyanda! Oh! I wish I can make it up to you, my dear Siyanda. I began to cry, I never cry, yet I am lost without my dear Siyanda. She was my fortress, my healer! Yet, she never trusted in me again when her red mustang never came back. Oh!? She blamed it on me! I told her that James really needed her red mustang for work and that I decided to stay with her for a while. Just like she wanted! But no!? She never cared for me like we cared before after that moment. To me, my dear Siyanda is still in love with me. Although, I think that my dear Siyanda and Siyanda are drifting apart? All of my hard work loving my dear Siyanda and caring for my family is for not. All because of what? A car? Cars can be replaced with hard work, yet relationships need harder work to be built back together again than a car. At some point, the work is too much for anyone and the relationship falls apart like a string getting stretched more and more, till that poor thing breaks! Crying my eyes out, I couldn't think straight. My dear Siyanda tried to live with me for most of the month, yet we drifted apart, no matter how close we got. I am going to tell my dear Siyanda that I want a divorce by tomorrow. I don't want to do it, but for my dear Siyanda to be happy again, I have to.

I tried my best to distract myself from my misery. I looked around at the themes that Partaceyist Fishes adored. I saw bright glowing wooden logs go across the log cabin. I saw fishing rods galore, banners of the full-timers here, stuffed Walleyes, chefs cooking Walleye, the enriching smell of Walleye, and so many gleeful people in such a tiny space! I looked around with a weak turning of my head to see any distractions that I could use to get my head to stop thinking of my dear Siyanda. I suddenly saw that I was standing right next to a large tank with a plank on it. The plank read, "Guthrie the Walleye." I stood in awe of such a big tank. I looked at the chunky Walleye that was in this tank. He must have been about as large as 5 pounds; Guthrie was a big boy indeed. While I was staring at the tank and the chunky layers of Guthrie, Guthrie suddenly turned his head around at me. We both stared at each other, I just was done with this world. I wanted to be free from its chains and I am dreading this life!

Staring at Guthrie with a dreadful stare of sadness and despair, it felt like to me that Guthrie was looking back at me with a glance of loving and respecting care for me.

I felt dizzy, yet I wanted to stare into this Walleye's soul! I wanted to know his secrets! I want to know how to get the glance of love to others, I need it for my dear Siyanda! I stared with determined dread in my eyes at Guthrie, yet Guthrie stared into my eyes with to what I can only assume to be calm respect for me. We are two worlds apart, both in the physical and mental space, yet I felt a soft connection to Guthrie that I had never felt with anyone before. A connection of not being connected, soft in its composition, yet hard in its realized form. I felt that we were both opposites, which connected our fates together as one. Suddenly, a man tapped on my shoulders, and I zapped out of it. Guthrie then turned his head away from me and I noticed that it was my turn to get a list.

I got a list and when I looked at my list, I instantly knew what I wanted to do. I wanted to try and be a laughter performer, for just one person. On the list, it said that I could be a worker for as long as Partaceyist Fishes is open for today, yet I want to keep my time here relatively short, in case someone here finds me suspicious. I am doing this because I truly just want to help Partaceyist Fishes as much as I can. Also, maybe that Walleye by the Pound everyone is raving about will stop me from crying inside. So, I finished my paperwork, placed my list in my pocket, and I began my duty. Walking in a slow slothful stride, I reached a table full of kids. I thought to myself that kids are the easiest people to make happy, so this is my best shot. If I can cheer up these kids, then it may cheer me up too. So, I walked up to the kids and said in a fake-like funny tone, "Howdy partners! Who want to party with me?" The kids looked at me with confusion, yet one looked like they were interested in my proposal. So, I continued, pointing at a kid who I thought was liking my stunt, "Do you want to party with me? I can do the cookie woo-key!" I spun myself around like a two year old without a care of this world. I twirled, danced, waved my hands, and even dabbed at the kid.

Spinning around, I became a show for the people and the kids. It was a quick, yet relieving feeling. So, I decided to show off my spinning skills by twirling and jumping at the same time. I twirled like a monkey without a wallet! It was insanity and for a moment I was having fun. Whenever I completed a twirl, the customers at the restaurant would cheer me on in a gleeful fashion. The customers would raise their waters up and down in gleeful unison with my jumps up and down. After a minute of twirling and dancing for the kids, I decided to bring my a-game up a

notch. I decided to jump and twirl at the same time. Yet, I failed so hard, and my feet missed their landing on the floor. I felt my foot bend like an empty bottle of toothpaste. A sharp sensation of pain overwhelmed me, and I fell over onto the floor with a loud bang. When I fell onto the shiny clean floor, I could hear the kid I was trying to give laughter towards beginning to cry as loud as a siren on wheels. Whilst I lay on the floor, staring at the crying kid, I heard the crying roar of an orchestra of crying children. The suffering that I was hearing was loud, uproarious, and painful to my ears. Yet, on that clean floor, I could only think about one thing, why? I had it in the bag, yet when I decided to work harder, I then turned my released joy into sadness. It made me cry like a baby that had lost its own mother!

Partaceyist Fishes is supposed to be a caring refuge for hard work, a refuge for the joy of the customers. Yet, when I use hard work here, it created suffering? No, that's impossible! The more work one does, the better the outcome becomes! That's the way of this world! The nature of hard work cannot be changed! Yet, here I am, witnessing a different reaction towards my hard work that shouldn't be possible. What is happening? I was becoming dizzy in confusion, was hard work even successful!? How could I know the answer to that? I have been struggling with that answer for a month, yet no answer was in sight. As if it was an unanswerable question, destined to destroy me and my joy of service. Yes, my joy of service, what happened? I am a good worker, yet here, I have failed with my duty to this kid. I must do something to help this kid out! So, I said with a deep sorrowful tone in my voice, "Kid, I am sorry." The kid, crying with so much force that it felt like the kid was an Olympian crier. I wanted to walk away from this situation, yet I couldn't. My leg was in such deep pain, and it was sideways. I was very disturbed, looking at my sideways leg, no wonder that kid and all of the other kids were crying.

Oh?! I just wanted to help out with the business that I helped create, yet my help had only hurt my business. Wait, this business is not mine, why am I asserting that it is? In my head, I internally groaned, Oh—?! I don't know? I don't know? Why!? Why!? Oh, why!? I tried to put myself together by reassuring in my head that this precious business that I helped build is now all grown up. When your children grow up, it is only natural to let them go to achieve wonders on their own. Children? Wait, oh my poor dear Siyanda!? I already miss you Siyanda! I wanted

to forget you, but I can't. Now, the very thing that we wanted to help work on together is falling apart!? Crying and shaking in disbelief, I laid on the clean floor to what felt like forever, then suddenly I heard a thud next to me. I tried to look at where that thud came from. It looked to be a man with crutches. The man then said to me, "Sir, are you ok?" I shook my head sideways. Signaling that I was not ok. The man then elevated my leg with the help of a couple of the customers. Another customer then handed out a medical kit to the man. The man then started to wrap a thick layering of medical tape on my leg. The man wrapped my leg with so much tough-looking medical tape that I could only see white where my leg was at. I couldn't move that leg either. Then, the customers and the man lifted me up and placed crutches under my armpits.

The man then said to me while he was looking at my leg, "Sir, I loved your little dance for the kids. Your sacrifice is very appreciated here at Partaceyist Fishes. Do you want a hug, sir?" I instinctively nodded, I was so surprised that this man was caring for me. It was so unbelievable, yet believable at the same time. Although, I didn't know if this man was trying to earn money by respecting me or not. Yet, why did it matter? Genuine or not, the outcome is still the same. I am able to walk now. It's not like I had to pay him or something, I at least knew that is not how Partaceyism works. His respect for me generates wealth for himself and for me too, to what I remember from reading *The Partaceyist Manifesto*, that's how Partaceyism works.

Yet, I needed a hug after the confusion and dread that consumed me. So, I said to the man, "Yes, please. I would love that." So, the man, most of the customers, the kids, and all of the workers within the eating area hugged me. Their presence was full, I saw them all with concern in their eyes, they all went to me and hugged me! Worker or customer, friends or family, it doesn't matter right now. What matters is these people stopped their roles in society, and they were helping me in my struggle. It felt so different to what I was used to at a business. I honestly didn't believe it was real, yet real or not, it happened and that is what matters at the end of the day. After what felt like a few minutes, I said to the customers and workers hugging me, "Guys and girls, I feel better now." The customers and workers, nodding in agreement with me, then scattered and went back to their roles in society. Yet, it felt that their roles in society were not as real as I initially thought.

The distinctions between a worker and a customer here are blurry to me.

Yet, what should I expect? This is a Partaceyist business, where everyone is a part of the business. It seems that not even the customers are left out in the forging of the identity and character of the business. So, limping on my crutches, I decided to head to the converter station, so that I can see if I can get a deal on a Walleye order here. Limping on my crutches as I headed towards the line for the converter station, I noticed that there were only a few people waiting in line. It looked like there were about twelve people in line. Waiting in line, I looked around the humble log cabin. The Walleye esthetic here really gave this place a character of its own. It was what I had imagined, but far more than what I had realized in my imagination. Although, I couldn't help but think that the whole worker-customers dynamic thing felt kind of addicting to me. One could work here longer and do more actions and that person may increase their deal on a Walleye order from their respect to others. It was like gambling, yet gambling had a different character than this. Gambling was addictive in its possibility for people to win big. Here, the working here was addictive in the ease of generating respect and the possibility of getting a better deal on Walleye by doing something as simple as respecting others. Gambling was destructive in its addiction to the wallet, yet here this addictive feeling could only help the wallet grow. This was gambling if gambling only gave this world love and joy to others. It was a humbling experience indeed.

Before I even knew it, it was finally my turn to convert my respect into cash. Yet, when I looked up at the converter guy, I was shocked. It was James! The guy that ruined my life. The guy that took everything from me, even my dear Siyanda! Why hasn't James ever returned her beautiful red mustang? Was it too good for him to give it back to us? I was blinded by the possibility of success, so my consciousness was not in the right spot when I allowed James to borrow her red mustang. Yet, right now, I knew James was not a man to be trusted. Yet, I noticed that James looked at me with overwhelming glee in his eyes. He looked at me like how a boy going into universal would look at his dad. Pure glee? What is happening? So, I tried to walk with my crutches towards James. James then said to me with a happily playful voice, "Jay! It's been a month since I last saw you! What's been happening? You were so great out their old pal!" Old pal? He must be insane? He tried to steal my wallet, then he stole my dear Siyanda's car and now he has the

audacity to call me old pal? No, he is either crazy or evil inside. Regardless, I wanted the integrity of what I helped build to stay alive. So, I ask James, “Sir, here is my list, I will be waiting at that corner over there when my respect is calculated. Thank you.” I then noticed that I couldn’t get my list out of my pocket. Although, a man next to me looked at me with concern in his eyes. He then grabbed my list out of my pocket, and he gave it to James for me.

I wanted to leave the presence of James, yet James gave me a concerned look and quickly said to one of his buddies next to him, “I am taking a break, please ask Teddy to do Jay’s calculation for me.” I then saw the most dreaded thing imaginable, James came up to me! The man who comes towards me every time leads to my life getting worse and worse. James then directed me to sit down next to him. I didn’t want to show my anger of James to the business. Although, Partaceyist Fishes is too precious to destroy for my own selfish desires. I had no choice but to accept James’s intent to talk to me. Yet, I really wanted to take revenge for what James had done to me. So, I struggled to position myself on the seat and a couple of worker-customers saw me with concern in their eyes and they came towards me. The what I assumed to be worker-customers then helped elevate me enough to sit down with James. James looked at me and with a calm concern voice said to me, “Jay, I don’t know why you look so angry. We did it. Partaceyist Fishes is alive and well. I did what you told me to do, I saved Partaceyist Fishes!”

I looked at James with confusion in my eyes. I told him to save my business, not to steal my dear Siyanda’s red mustang! No wait, it is our business, we put in the work to build it, yes? Did I? I bailed Partaceyist Fishes when things got rough for me. So, is Partaceyist Fishes really still my business? I don’t know? Oh!? I can’t answer that? What is this! I should know this! Partaceyist Fishes is of course my business, I made the idea! Oh wait, I may of thought of the idea, but James did decide the name of my idea. So, is this business mine or his? I must ask him this question. James looked like he was about to say something to me in his facial expression, yet I didn’t care about what James felt. That was not important to me. What is important is that I needed my question answered, so I said to James, “Hey James, is this business yours or mine?” James looked at me with a deep sense of confusion in his eyes. His confusion enraged me, James is in no place to be confused! I bet he knows what he did to me, and he is hiding it from me!

James then said to me in a confused tone, “What?” I then re-said my question to James with more vigor in my voice, “James!? Is this business yours or mine?” James looked at me with concern drooling from his eyes. James then said to me with an oddly calm voice, “Jay, what is this about? This is our business.” I looked at James with a bold stare and said to him in a stern tone, “If this is our business, then why are none of us working right now?” James looked at me with laughter that he looked to be holding in. James then said to me with a calm happily tone, “Uh-huh, you're right. None of us are working right now, but this happens all of the time when we were at Benchmarks Seafood. I remember every night I would sleep, and you would too. So, Jay, who owned Benchmarks Seafood during the night?” I looked at James with conviction and said to him in a blunt tone, “I owned Benchmarks Seafood, day and night.” James looked at me with a glance that looked like he accepted that answer. James then said to me in a calm tone, “Jay, to me, ownership is not built on work, it is built on something much greater than that.” I was curious in what James had to say, so I asked James with a curious tone in my voice, “What is that?” James then said with a happily smile, “Jay, ownership is—.”

The man who took James’s place on the converter station suddenly interrupted James and said in a loud playfully concerned voice, “Hey James, I forgot how to convert money into respect again. It is really hard to remember. James, can you please help me?” James turned his head at the man and said to him in an annoyed, yet calm voice, “Teddy? I am in the middle of something right now.” I saw what was happening, James could be forced to go back to work. I was really uncomfortable with James next to me, so I tried to get James back to work again by saying to the man on the converter station in a shocked tone, “Oh, I think I forgot my love valuation on my list, can you please check it for me?” The man looked at my list and said in a surprised voice, “Wow, you are right. It’s all good though, just say your opinion on how respectful your action towards that child was out of a range of 100 was.” After hearing what the man had to say, I thought about how I respected that action. I thought carefully about my answer. If I wasn’t honest, then I may hurt this business that I helped to create once again. So, I said back to him, “I believe that my respect to that child was a 60-100 because I may have hurt that child in the short-term, but the love generated from my suffering eased the pain of

everyone within the restaurant.” The man then responded back to me in a cheerful manner, “Good answer!” James looked at me as if he wanted to talk to me about something. I don’t know what else we need to talk about. We didn’t talk at all last month, so what was needed to be talked about so urgently right now?

Anyway, the man then looked at a computer screen for a minute. Oh no! That is very bad! James can now talk at me again! Oh no! James then looked at me with his concerned eyes and said to me, “Where was I, Jay?” Wait—, James lost track of what he was talking about? This was my chance! I said to James in a calmed voice, “You were talking about our business, but you needed to go back to work.” With a smile on my face, I thought I had finally got rid of James, yet to my dismay James responded back to me in a cheerful tone, “Oh! I remember now! Jay, we are talking about who owns this business. The truth is none of us now owns this business. It is owned in common by the full-timers and the most dedicated customers that want to attend our business meetings.” I knew I should stop thinking about my place in Partaceyist Fishes, for I now have none.

Although, I felt a deep desire to know the future direction of Partaceyist Fishes. To me, it is like a father leaving his sons, yet a year down the line, that father asks his sons how they are doing. That feeling was in me right now. So, to think that the customers are a part of the decision process at Partaceyist Fishes was to put it lightly to me, unexpected. Suddenly, the man said to me in a sales pitch-like voice, “Your love valuation is 60-100 and my love valuation for your action is 70-100. I really loved the energy your failure created. Let’s see, $60 + 70 = 130$ divided by 200, then subtract both love valuations by one respectfully, which equals a disrespect percentage of 0.35 for your one action. If I just quickly calculate the pay and convert it to USD, then you get, oh wow! You got a 185 dollars and 63 cents contribution towards the collective rise for doing one action for Partaceyist Fishes! This is amazing! Wheehee...!! You’ll get paid by the end of the week. Do you want cash back or fish?” James suddenly said in a playfully angry voice, “Hey, that’s my line!” I said back to the man, “I want the Walleye by the Pound order, please.” The man then walked up to me and I gave him 10 dollars. He looked at me confused like an unplayful rubber ducky, but he looked to give me a quick glance, to which I could only make out a slight smirk on his face before he began to walk away from me. I decided that due to my current state I wanted to stay seated where I was at.

While I was waiting for my Walleye, I thought about Partaceyist Fishes as a business, if I don't give a donation to Partaceyist Fishes, then what type of founder am I? Besides, I can get money back from the simple action of donating. So, I said back to the man, "I also want to donate 10 dollars towards Partaceyist Fishes!"

I tried to reach into my pocket to get my wallet and after some odd struggle with my awkward positioning, I eventually pulled out a ten-dollar bill. I wanted to ask a person waiting in line if they could bring my money to the station. Although James grabbed my arm before I could reach my hand out to the person. James then said to me with concern dwelling in his eyes, "Jay, I can take it over there, I care for you. We are always a team, co-owners or not." I accepted James's request; I wanted James out of my sight anyway. As James walked up towards the converter station, I thought to myself, James cares for me? No, he doesn't! If he did, he would have brought back my dear Siyanda's red mustang. Wait—, did I care for James at all? Ugh! I don't know? Why does that matter? He didn't care for me when I needed it the most! Even back when we worked at Benchmarks Seafood, we didn't care for each other! I didn't even care for Uncle Henry back then! Wait for the pickle jar! What did I just think up of? I didn't care for Henry? Well, yes, I didn't care for him. We didn't know each other that well. Yet, I did see Henry die in front of my face. I should at least be true to my beliefs and do the work to make things right with Henry. He did die. Well, yeah, he did, but why does that mean I need to make things right with him? He's dead!

Suddenly, the man said back to me, "Sir, how many actions were done to make this ten-dollar bill?" I responded back at the man, "I don't know? Money doesn't keep track of that, I guess given that my salary was forty dollars an hour at Benchmarks Seafood that I did like four actions to get those ten dollars?" The man said back know me with a joyous tone in his voice, "That's all I needed, for your sake, do you remember the respect you attribute to those actions?" I thought about it, but Henry's memory was beginning to pollute my mind. Wait—, I began to think about my actions that I did to receive those ten dollars at Benchmarks Seafood. Looking at my surroundings to compare my memories back then with, I thought that my actions back then felt inferior to the joy bubbling up around here. I knew then that my 10 dollars must have been less respectful than any actions that were done here at Partaceyist Fishes. So, as Henry's memory began to dominate my mind, I

decided to say to the man in a slightly sorrowful voice that, “My best guess is that those actions have love valuations of 20-100, 10-100, 40-100, and 30-100 for those 10 dollars. Although, sir, that's a complete guess.” The man then said back to me with glee in his eyes, “Sir, the beauty about Partaceyism is that it doesn't matter if what you said is objectively true or not. What matters is that you believe it to be true.” I sat there in awe, what I believed to be true? What was that? Was it that hard work is what can make a man find purpose in life? I don't know? What on Earth is happening to me? What I do know is that right now, I believe that I need to go to Henry's tombstone and say that I am sorry to him, so that I can try to once again live up to being a hard worker.

The man then said back to me, “Since, no one here knows of a witness to your actions, I will simply record them as stated. It is a donation after all. So, for your knowledge, in love valuations you have given us. Uh-huh, let's see, 0.8, 0.9, 0.6, and 0.7. All added up, that's a 3% disrespect percentile. Therefore, the total pay of 150 respect wealth subtracted by three, which makes that 147 respect wealth, or about \$49 dollars. Thank you for the donation, kind sir!” I looked at the man with a weak smile on my face. The love economy is surely a miracle. Of course! If I sent a disrespectful 10 dollars in, I would have a poor respect wealth generated for my donation. Yet, I was confused as to where did my 10 dollars go? I only heard my actions being counted. I then asked the man with a confused tone, “Sir? What happened to my 10 dollars?” He looked at me with glee and said back to me, “Your 10 dollars became the actions that you earned that cash with, meanwhile your 10 dollars in the physical sense, was put into our daily expense fund. You keep your earned \$49 dollars, it's not included into the collective rise. That's how it's done. If you want the transaction reversed, then say so.” I shook my head back and forth with a hint of sorrow within the movement of my head. I didn't want to cause any confusing trouble. I just wanted to leave Partaceyist Fishes, I had a calling to follow, and I believed I needed to do it now.

So, I got my crutches and some customers saw me and came towards me to help me back up. Once I got back up, I thanked the customers, and I limped towards the exit door. Whilst I was limping, I heard a voice say to me in a sorrowful tone, “Jay! You forgot about your order and your wealth from your donation! Jay! My friend, can you hear me?!” Once I heard that voice, I knew that it could only be James, so

I ignored it. I did my part for Partaceyist Fishes and James didn't deserve to be friends with me. I guess I will try the Walleye here another time. Although, right now I needed to go to Henry, I felt it within me, calling me like a dolphin being called for a show. Yet, I wanted to see James suffer, like how I am suffering. So, I glanced back at James while I was limping towards the exit. He had what appeared to be a very confusing, concerned and sorrowful composure as I limped away from him. With a smile, I then quickly turned my head away from the direction of James and towards the exit door. As I got next to the exit door, a couple of customers came to help me by opening the exit door for me. One customer then said to me in a concerned tone, "Sir, do you want my help leaving?" I was struggling to leave the restaurant in a quick fashion, and I didn't know how I was going to get into my new car? So, I said to the customer, "Yes, I do, thank you." Limping with the customer, I limped my way out of the log cabin of Partaceyist Fishes. Although, while I was limping out of the building, I saw a familiar person in the distance hanging out next to a car. I had no idea who it was, but I just felt that I had seen that person before. When I fully got out of the building, the customers said to me with glee, "Bye, have a good day!" Then, the customers closed the exit door behind me as I limped onto the parking lot beyond.

(Kent's viewpoint) I laid on my car while looking at that curious log cabin at the mall parking lot. A log cabin in the middle of a parking lot? Why? Who knows? I certainly don't know why someone would build a log cabin in the middle of a parking lot. Yet, looking around the log cabin, it was clear that something was working here, which is why I came here. I wanted to observe Partaceyist Fishes' strategy for success. Yet, I couldn't find anything that stuck out to me. It just looked like an out of place Walleye themed restaurant to me. I am outside though. I then suddenly saw three regular looking cars that parked next to the log cabin. The people who drove those cars were carrying Walleye. I wondered while looking at the Walleye they were carrying in their large containers if they ever caught any other types of fish other than Walleye? It's not like Walleye is the only fish in the sea. There are so many more types of fish, yet they did Walleye, my baby! My own sweet sector of the fish restaurant market! Oh! Is it because of these yodeling mongrels that Fortengal Seafoods had to permanently close down yesterday? My brother hates me now! He thinks that I destroyed his business, yet it wasn't my fault, it was Partaceyist Fishes' hypercompetitive business that was at fault.

Looking around the surrounding environment, I spotted a lake hidden within the tree line. Next to the lake, I spotted a parking lot and a dock next to it. There was a single car parked in that parking lot. While I compared the cars, I saw a lake in the distance. I could just tell that Partaceyist Fishes gets their Walleye from that lake. I don't know if they are being environmentally friendly to the lake or not? Although, I would like to believe that Partaceyist Fishes is not being environmentally friendly. It may help me in any future business endeavor that I may try to attempt. Even if it looked like Partaceyist Fishes only had four regular sized cars for a lake that looked to be a mile long. Yet, regardless of that, what matters right now is that currently I am business-less. I am unable to currently serve my community, since Fortengal Seafoods has fallen. I guess that is the free market after all? My thoughts lingered onto my purpose while I was finishing my sentence.

Wait just a minute—, oh no! Oh my! My world is collapsing into despair without my ability to serve my community. The Fortengal Family has distanced itself from me. Oh no, I am alone! At least I had Samantha while I ran Fortengal Seafoods, but no. I didn't know it at the time, but I witnessed Samantha's death, and I am clueless as to why? I felt a sense of sadness for Samantha passing, yet she was never truly dear to me. What made her death really hurt was when High Speeders decided to pull away from my deal with them. Thus, a cycle of increased delivery costs and decreased demand spelled the end for my beautiful refuge for hard workers. Samantha was my vital connection in the management circle of High Speeders, it is how I got connected to the CEO of High Speeders in the first place. Yet, with Samantha as dead as a dodo, I have no one to truly support my case for my local establishment at the large corporation of High Speeders. The management then quickly thought that my deal was too much for them to bear in comparison to the small size of Fortengal Seafoods.

My investment, my dream, my business, my family, and my everything went down the drain like a dead mosquito in a dirty public shower! Everything means nothing now! I just wanted to serve others and to bring them joy! What happened to me? Where did I go wrong? I assume that the Partaceyist Fishes Company is what took my customers away. They fled like livestock! As if my business wasn't good

enough for them. Well, I'll see what history will teach to Partaceyist Fishes and I will wait to find it out myself. I deserve it! I am a hard worker! Hard workers own this world! It is the way of this world! It is the moral direction this world has taken for centuries! My hard work at Fortengal Seafoods will predestine me to have success later in my life, even if I have to work for that success to come once again. It is the eternal rule of this world! It is the gift of service to all that do the hard work and serve others.

Trying to calm my anguish, I looked at the log cabin and the surrounding parking lot. It was a place where kids did feel joyous. In a parking lot out of all places? Certainly, Partaceyist Fishes has a ring of success to it. Yet, I never heard of Partaceyist Fishes during my time with High Speeders. How did Partaceyist Fishes get its supplies? Certainly, they must have a delivery company associated with them. Oh wait, that lake, those brilliant idiots! Hahaha! How can they claim to be a place of respect when they don't respect the existence of Fortengal Seafoods! They don't even respect me and my right for service! They are using that lake as a place to get their Walleye! Stealing the possibilities for small businesses to flourish here! Maybe I am wrong? I simply don't know if I am right or wrong. That's the funny part! One person can't know everything, that's why we serve others, to find the truth inside of us. I began to open my door to my car, but I noticed out of the corner of my eye a faint familiar looking person in the distance. Yet, I couldn't figure out who that person was. Anyway, I saw him limping next to a car. When I saw that person, my hand began to instinctively shake. While looking at the mysterious person, I then saw a woman next to him. She was opening the car door for the person and tucking the person into the car. Wow, that's weird. People don't see that every day. I then started to lose interest in the woman, she looked to be unimportant, then the woman closed the car door, and she then went around the car to likely go into the driver's seat of the car.

(Jay's viewpoint) I adjusted myself a little bit more. Then, I reached out my hand to open the door for the customer. It was only right that I opened the door for her since she helped me get into my car. I then helped her close the door, since I felt that I should at least try to help her because she was helping me too. I needed her since I cannot drive in my current state. The lady asked me in a calm manner, "Where do you want to go?" I responded to her, "I want to go to the Grand Rapids

Graveyard.” She then said in glee, “Oh, that’s not far away! Do you want me to wait for you when you’re done with your visit.” Shocked by the kindness of the woman, I could only respond with a nod. So, we went off into the sunset. The day was slowly losing its brightness as I left the atmosphere of Partaceyist Fishes. While the woman was driving me to see Henry, I thought about what I said to James about customers serving others is not moral. I thought about all of the care and compassion at Partaceyist Fishes that the customers gave to me. It showed me that I was wrong. It can be moral to allow customers to serve others, since they are humans like the workers within a company. What was I thinking when I told James that customers shouldn’t be workers too? Looking back at it, it was against my own moral code of promoting hard work and dignity to others to disagree with James.

Although, why hard work? Why should I value hard work after all of this time? My love for hard work is confusing for me to understand. Yet, hard work is what makes this world go around. Without work, humanity would be nothing and without service, humanity would be fragmented mongrels of death and destruction. It is why duty and hard work are such important attributes in this world. Without them, everything just falls apart. Suddenly, the car stopped, and the woman said to me, “We have made it.” So, she opened the door for me, and she helped me get back up onto my crutches. She then said to me, “Should I keep the door open for you, in case we need a quick exit for an emergency?” I looked at the woman with eyes of dread and acceptance and said, “Yeah, keep the door open and call the police if I don’t come back soon. It is becoming night time. Thank you, miss.” So, I limped my way towards Henry’s tombstone. Yet, I had no idea where his tombstone was. Slowly limping in the darkening darkness, I couldn’t find Henry’s tombstone anywhere in sight. It took me hours limping along the gravestones of the past dwellers of this world to finally find Henry’s tombstone.

Henry’s tombstone was a modest circular tombstone that had a base on the bottom of it. It looked like a regular tombstone, yet it looked new. It should be, it is only a month old. Standing with my crutches in front of Henry’s tombstone, I thought about that fateful incident. I could’ve just helped him when I saw him. Yet, I waited because I didn’t know what to do at that moment. I remembered how Henry died; he just ungracefully fell onto the concrete of the dark sidewalk. It was a death with so little work to allow it to happen that it felt wrong. Wait? Henry died with

little effort needed, yet his death is why I left Partaceyist Fishes. My dream, the reason that I sacrificed everything in my life, I have just completely abandoned. All because I wanted to say something to Henry? What on Earth am I doing? It is futile to go against hard work, I would be a mongrel to do such a thing! So, why did I just do that? Did I just do something that wasn't because of hard work at all? What?! I suddenly realized something amazing. I was here, in the darkness, looking at Henry's tombstone, not because of the hard work I wanted to do to heal myself. No—, I was here because I felt that I didn't respect Henry and I felt that Henry needed to be respected. Wow! Holy cow! Does that mean that respect is greater than work? No, it cannot be! Respect is more important than work? Impossible, yet here I am. What else could explain this? Then it hit me, like the discovery of gravity, it hit me.

I began to realize that within the contexts of a society built on Supply and Demand, the increase in the supply of disrespect leads to the increasing demand for respect. Yet, a contradiction exists. Those that work hard to achieve that respect that they demand can never have it. This is because respect cannot be obtained from hard work. Respect can only be obtained with respect itself because being respectful is a choice and work is forcefully enforced upon society, so doing hard work is not a choice. Hence, the more the supply of respect increases, the more that person will demand respect. If someone worked hard to try to achieve that respect, which I wanted to do for the whole world to respect my own business. Then, they will fall into the pit of disrespectfulness and despair. They will become mongrels of death and destruction! Wait? Nooooo!?! This cannot be?! But it must be! This is the truth! All because of with just hard work, one can never achieve true respect for another. It is only with embracing respect above your own work that one can avoid becoming disrespectful to others and to themselves.

Thus, this whole time I have been embracing hard work over respect. This had allowed me to be consumed by the forces of Supply and Demand by demanding respect with my supply of hard work. Although, it looks like that is not a reflection of the world we live in. We live in a world dominated innately by people, not supply and demand. So, what the people truly want is what becomes the innate rules of this world! Oh no! No, no, no, that means that I have been disrespectful to everyone that I have ever known! I had been casting disrespect and misfortune onto

everything I touched. I must of had terrible parents! I had disrespected my dear Siyanda, James, my employees at Benchmarks Seafood, that woman who I crashed into, my sons, Jared, and even you, Henry. I had thought that service was a duty, it is not!

Service is a choice, one that must be done with respect to the one being served! When serving, I was only doing the duty of the beast of Supply and Demand! I was a tool to try to increase respect for my hard work to serve the customers! The innate incentives interwoven into hard work makes me want more respect, which makes me more desperate, which ultimately makes me focus on my greed, and then I inadvertently cast disrespect on everything I touched! Supply and Demand corrupted me because I loved my hard work! I could have been satisfied with love as it flows naturally within life, but no! I had to follow the wishes of Supply and Demand! I had to be a hard worker and become a slave to the beast of Supply and Demand! That's what was wrong with seeing service as a duty! Seeing service as a duty rather than a respectable choice consumed me into a pathetic path of disrespect and sadness in my wake, which ruined the very service I was trying to constantly do!

So, that also means that my greatest meaning in life, meaning being derived from enduring another hard day working, is also horrendously wrong! For if respect is greater than work, then that means that success is tied up with respect, not hard work. That explains everything! I was unsuccessful with my dear Siyanda because I didn't use the most successful path to satisfy her. I used the path of hard work, which didn't have success in it, but it did have failure within it. Work is failure pretending to be successful! For it is not what I do that matters, it is what I understand that matters! That can explain why I am here. I am here because respect brought me here! I am here to understand why I desire to talk to Henry, and I think I know why. I wanted to talk to Henry Tabor because I respected that he came to me for help. Even when I casted him away from me, Henry Tabor, the man, the myth, and the legend still had hope that I would help him. So, I stared at Henry's tombstone, only being lit by the dim moonlight. I then said to Henry's tombstone in a deep regretful voice, "Henry, I am sorry for not helping you when you came to me. Please rest, it is because of you that I am now saved."

I then realized that I had escaped my struggle! I am free! Free from the chains of Supply and Demand. Free to be a true Partaceyist and to be a part of the Partaceyist business that my community around me helped to create. Feeling at ease with myself, I slowly began to zap out of my transient mode of thought. I looked around Henry's tombstone and the dim moon light gave way to a note on the top of Henry's tombstone. I stared at the note, why was there a note next to Henry's tombstone? I decided to pick it up to see what it said. I struggled to reach it at first, but using my crutches as balancing tools, I eventually got the note. I looked at the paper note, and it read, "Dear Henry, I have done my duty for my community. I am just glad that I could help in finding your rest. You really did need it. Sincerely, you know who." Full of confusion and shock, I dropped the note on the ground. Who wrote this note and why? What was this person's relationship to my uncle? I had no clue at all. It creeped me out a lot. I wanted to go, now. So, I began to look up and adjust my crutches, but when I looked up, I saw a shadowy figure standing under a nearby tree.

I stood there, frozen in complete disbelief and shock. I didn't know what to do. I stared at the dark shadowy figure in the dark distance. I could not make out who it was. Then, suddenly I heard a loud bang and then a sudden jolt of pain hit my heart. In absolute shock, I threw my crutches in the air, and I fell. While I was falling, I saw my blood being sprayed all over Henry's tombstone. Oh, what irony is this? Henry is not going to help me just like when I didn't help Henry in his own death. I heard a faint chuckle in the distance, as my sense of reality faded away. I suddenly saw my blood spilt all over Henry's tombstone, which reminded me of my wife's lingering question to me. What can turn death into fortune? Well, as my body began to fall, I embraced my mind around that question.

Death is such a meaningful experience to witness, yet it doesn't require any hard work to achieve. A simple slash or gunshot will do the trick. Yet, death is so meaningful, in fact death is more meaningful than anything that life can bring. Death is fortune because death requires no hard work to achieve. It is pure respect, as if when we die, we live. Death brings all of us out of our Supply and Demand enslavement towards respecting the one who died. It gives me hope that my dear Siyanda may mourn for me, for if she does, then she truly respects me. Death is given to all of us, it is not worked for. No matter what we do in this life, death will

mean the same. Yet, if we understand that it is what we understand that truly matters, then we can truly be our own in our life and see death with a free eye. If that's not worth a fortune, then I don't know what is. Suddenly, I felt a sudden whack on my head, and I began to feel dizzy. The world felt like it was ending, yet I knew it will go on without me. So, I looked up into the stars and I decided for once in my life to respect the shiny stars above because I wanted to. With that, my world went blank, and I felt an overwhelming sensation of rest within me.